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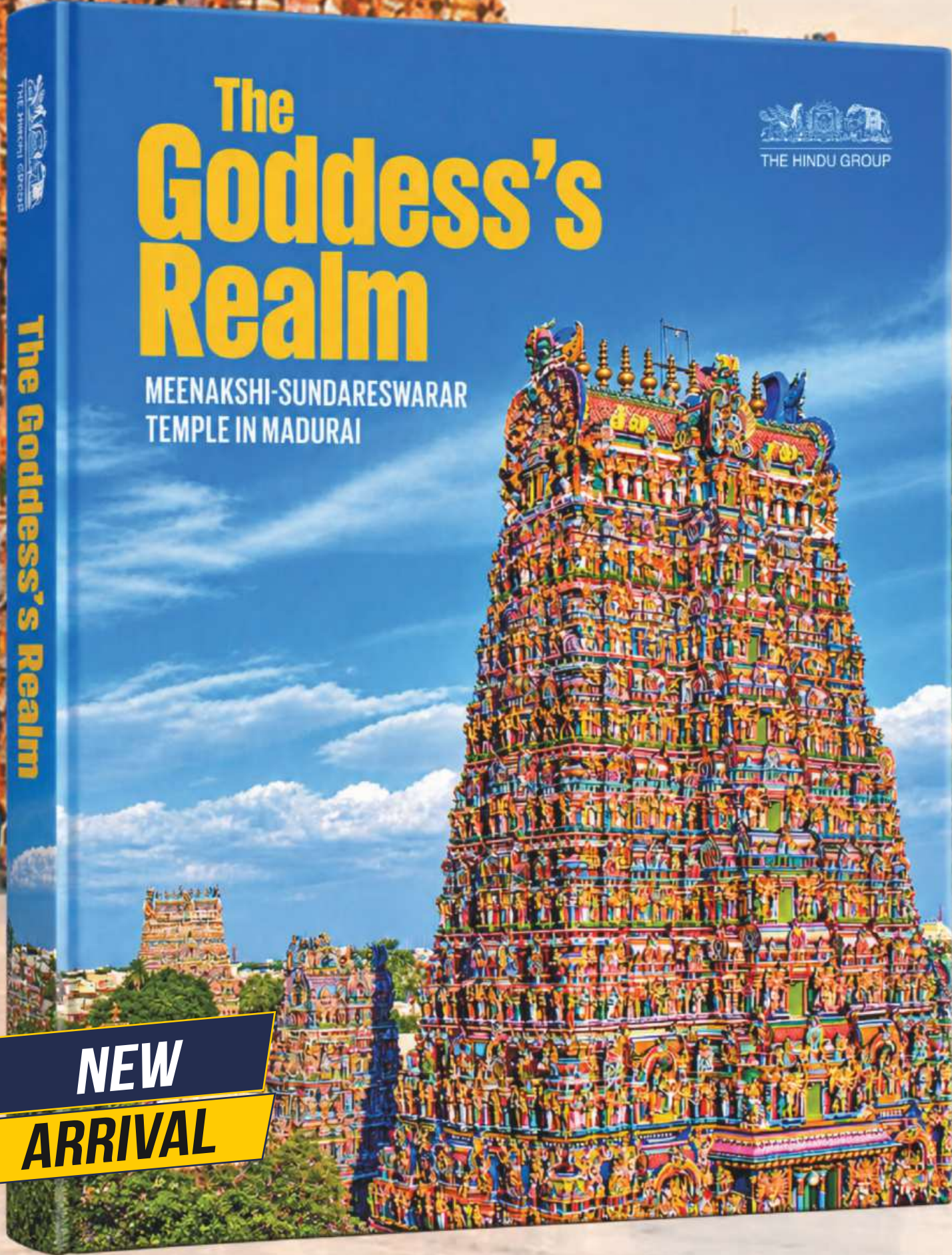
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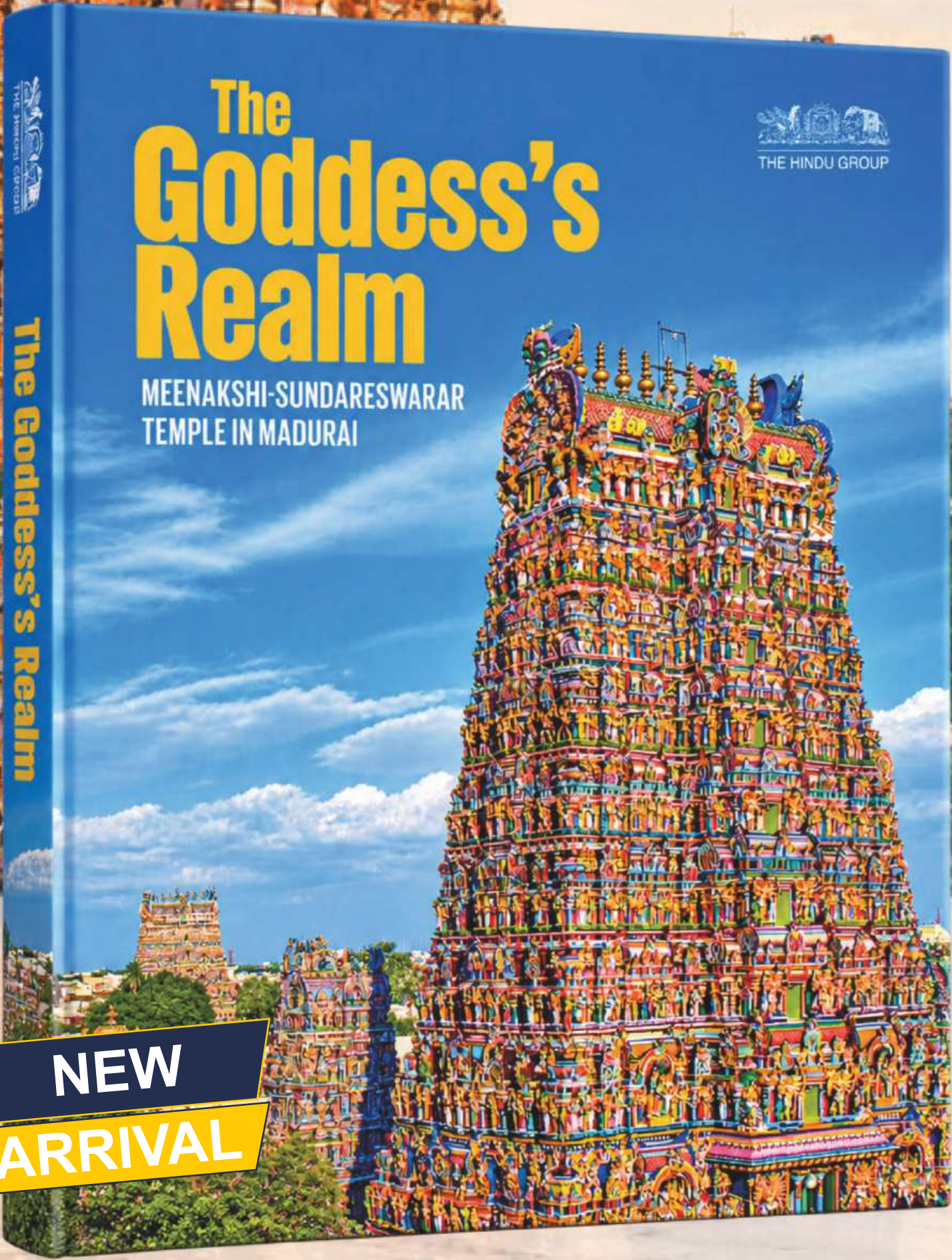
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Why the State is facing a power crisis

EXPLAINER

Tiki Rajwi

The story so far

After the weekly Cabinet meeting on Wednesday, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said his government was in touch with eight States and multiple power-sector agencies for securing emergency electricity supplies to tackle the ongoing power crisis. Mr. Satheesan also announced that the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government intended to float a revised power policy as well as short- and long-term plans for guaranteeing energy security. The announcements have come even as Keralaam is battling an unprecedented monsoon-season electricity shortage. State-owned Kerala State Electricity Board (KSEB) has imposed power curbs citing shortfall in power availability and soaring consumption during the evening hours.

The background

Keralam is heavily reliant on electricity 'imports' for meeting its growing requirement. Internal generation, mostly hydropower, meets a mere 30% of the demand. Supplies from the Central Generating Stations (CGS) and power purchases account for the remaining 70%. Recent years have been marked by a surge in the State's solar power capacity. Data with the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy place Kerala's rooftop solar capacity at 2,259.50 megawatts (MW) as on August 30. While this capacity addi-



Multiple and often unannounced power outages in the State have drawn flak from people. A scene from a shop at Nanthencode in Thiruvananthapuram during a power outage. NIRMAL HARINDRAN

tion is a remarkable achievement, it has not translated into energy security for the State, largely due to the failure to complement it with energy storage facilities. This has resulted in a curious situation—during the daytime, the KSEB has been surrendering electricity out of its CGS and round-the-clock (RTC) contracts to accommodate the solar power injected into the grid by prosumers. In the evening hours, when demand peaks, the utility is forced to rely on high-priced electricity to satisfy demand. The 2026 crisis reared its head in April at the height of the summer, forcing the KSEB to announce power curbs on a “limited scale” after 6 p.m. The curbs were attributed to increase in use of air-conditioners due to the summer, electric-vehicle charging after 6 p.m. and the shift to electric cooking following the LPG shortage triggered by

the West Asia crisis.

However, the crisis and the curbs have spilled over to the monsoon months, which is unprecedented for Keralam. The latest curbs began with the Grid Controller of India anticipating a deficit of 12,000 MW nationwide on September 2. As per a September 16 update from the KSEB, this issue is yet to be fully resolved. Besides, the monsoon months are the time when the KSEB is expected to return the electricity borrowed from elsewhere in the country under ‘swap’ deals to meet the domestic summer demand. But, even as early as July, a KSEB panel had warned of the “likelihood of further deterioration in the power scenario due to the anticipated impact of El Niño.”

The weak monsoon depleted the storage in hydel reservoirs, while the evening electricity demand has soared.

Why is the KSEB drawing flak?

In a nutshell, the crisis has once again exposed the weaknesses of Keralam’s power system and its dependence on electricity ‘imports.’ The KSEB has drawn sharp criticism for the night-time power curbs. In many places, outages are unannounced and occur multiple times, the people allege. Observers of the sector blame the KSEB for failing to anticipate and plan for the changing trends and patterns in the power sector. While the State’s solar power capacity has shot up, so has consumption. On Wednesday, Mr. Satheesan noted that the power demand this September has risen by almost 925 MW compared to September 2025. The power utility is yet to commission grid-scale battery energy storage systems (BESS) or pumped storage projects (PSP) which could have averted the crisis. The State Planning Board, in its Economic Review for 2025, had listed renewable energy integration and capacity expansion among the challenges facing the sector.

What the political row is all about

In May 2023, the Kerala State Electricity Regulatory Commission had rejected power supply agreements totalling 465 MW entered into by the KSEB citing procedural violations. The 25-year Design, Build, Finance, Own and Operate contracts were signed during the United Democratic Front (UDF) government’s term in 2014, but were cancelled when the Communist Party of India (Mar-

xist)-led Left Democratic Front (LDF) government was in power. Although the LDF government tried to get the supplies restored, it did not succeed. The UDF, which is now back in power, argues that had these contracts been restored, the present crisis could have been avoided.

The cost of the crisis

For a small State, Keralam’s annual expenditure on power purchases is huge. The KSEB spent ₹12,982.59 crore in 2023-24 and ₹12,749.65 crore in 2024-25 on purchases. This is bad news for the common consumers as additional spending on power procurement ultimately gets passed on to them through thermal fuel surcharges on electricity bills.

What are the long-term impacts?

The power crisis can adversely impact the State’s development prospects and plans to attract investment. For instance, on Wednesday, the Cabinet cleared the ‘Simplified and Accelerated Regulatory Approvals and Licences’ (SARAL Keralam) mechanism for fast-tracking clearances for investment proposals. In his Revised Budget for 2026-27, Mr. Satheesan had said his government was “steadfastly committed to ushering in a ‘New Age Kerala’ (Puthuyuga Keralam) - an era that harmonises economic growth driven by social justice backed by modern, environmentally responsible infrastructure development.” To make it happen, uninterrupted power supply remains a basic necessity.

Satheesan asks State to brace for rising heat, power demand

The Hindu Bureau

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan has urged the State to brace for a looming power crisis as the El Niño factor exacerbates global climate change. He said Keralam could face relatively high temperatures and, correspondingly, an upwardly spiralling power demand that the State would struggle to meet from October.

Mr. Satheesan set a one-week deadline for the government to mitigate the current power crisis bedevilling the State. However, he stressed the need for long-term strategic planning to transform Keralam into a power-surplus State. He was speaking to reporters after chairing a Cabinet meeting on Wednesday.

Mr. Satheesan identified climate-change-spurred unprecedented heat, surging power demand driven by the rise of electric vehicles and air conditioners, depleted hydel storage levels from a weak monsoon, and a national power-generation deficit as drivers of the current crisis.

He blamed the Left Democratic Front (LDF) government’s “unthoughtful scrapping” of the “fiscally advantageous” long-term power purchase agreement signed by the United Democratic Front (UDF) government with private power suppliers to ward off future shortages in 2011 for precipitating the situation.

Mr. Satheesan said prosumers in Keralam pro-

duced a significant amount of renewable energy, chiefly from solar. “Nevertheless, the previous LDF government failed to build sufficient storage capacity to harness the full potential of solar power. The UDF will redeem the LDF’s mistake. It will build surplus storage capacity in the years so the Kerala State Electricity Board (KSEB) can draw from batteries to meet demand when it peaks during the night hours,” he said.

Mr. Satheesan said new hydel projects were not environmentally or financially viable for Keralam. “The UDF will enlist the private sector for boosting Kerala’s power generation efforts. However, the government has no plans to privatise the KSEB,” Mr. Satheesan added.

Mr. Satheesan said that Keralam’s demand for uninterrupted, high-quality power would spiral upwards as the UDF government moved to exploit the latest developments in Artificial Intelligence, including data centres and electronic chip design and production, with the help of global private investment.

Mr. Satheesan said the government was negotiating a long-term power purchase agreement with various States, as well as the country’s thermal and nuclear power generation behemoths in the public sector. Mr. Satheesan said the power crisis was not unique to Kerala.

Consultations on draft tariff norms on Sept. 29, 30

The Hindu Bureau

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Kerala State Electricity Regulatory Commission (KSERC) will hold stakeholder consultations on its draft multi-year tariff (MYT) regulations on September 29 and 30. The regulations, once finalised, will govern electricity tariff-related matters for the five-year ‘control period’ starting 2027-28.

The consultations, planned in hybrid mode, will be held in morning and afternoon sessions on both days, commission headed by T.K. Jose said. The Court Hall of the commission at Vellayambalam here is the venue for the offline mode.

The commission has published the draft on its website. The proposals in the draft KSERC (Multi-Year Tariff) Regulations, 2026, are aimed at offering consumers wider choice, better price signals and improved service, while enabling electricity licensees (such as the KSEB) to manage demand, optimise the use of assets and preserve financial viability, the commission notes in the draft. The existing fuel surcharge formula has been replaced with a ‘fuel and power purchase cost adjustment surcharge’ mechanism.

Those who wish to participate should register on https://registration.kserc.sbs/ The help desk of the commission can be contacted on 0471-2735544. For details, visit www.erckerala.org.



IDSFFK honour for Nina Sabnani

The Hindu Bureau

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Eminent animation filmmaker Nina Sabnani has been chosen for the Lifetime Achievement Award of the 18th International Documentary and Short Film Festival of Kerala (IDSFFK), in recognition of outstanding contributions to documentary and short filmmaking. The award carries a cash prize of ₹2 lakh, a sculpture and a citation. Chief Minister V. D. Satheesan will present the award at the festival’s closing ceremony at Kairali Theatre, Thiruvananthapuram on September 30.

Ten films by Nina Sabnani will be screened at the festival, to be held from September 25 to 30 at Kairali, Sree, and Nila theatres in the capital. Ms.Sabnani, who received the National Film Award for Best Animation Film in 2016 for *Hum Chitra Banate Hain*, is an animator, illustrator, researcher and educator. Her films weave together art, storytelling, ethnography and oral traditions, with her collaborative works with artists and folk storytellers receiving national and international acclaim. Nina created the film *Hum Chitra Banate Hain* in collaboration with Sher Singh, a traditional Bhil artist from Madhya Pradesh. Her other notable films include *Mukand and Riaz*, *Tanko Bole Chhe (The Stitches Speak)* and *Baat Wahi Hai*.

BUSINESS CONNECT

Bhima opens new showroom in Cuddalore



Bhima’s Cuddalore showroom was inaugurated by cine actress Aishwarya Lekshmi. The event was attended by Bhima managing director Suhas M.S., director Navya Suhas, and Cuddalore Mayor Sundari Rajah.

Noorul Islam Law Academy inaugurated



Supreme Court Judge Augustine George Masih inaugurating the Noorul Islam Law Academy in the presence of Noorul Islam University chancellor M.S. Faizal Khan, pro vice-chancellor Shabinam Shafeek and vice-chancellor Tessy Thomas.

Sree Chithira Thirunal National Award 2026

Sree Chithira Thirunal Trust has instituted Sree Chithira Thirunal National Award to commemorate the late Sree Chithira Thirunal Balamara Varma, the last ruler of the erstwhile kingdom of Travancore. The award which carries a cash prize of Rs. 2 lakh and a citation plaque is meant to be presented every year to a personality from various walks of life for his/her outstanding contributions to the nation. This year’s judging committee includes T.P. Srinivasan (chairman), V.V. Rajesh (Mayor), T. Sathesh Kumar (managing trustee) and S. Pushpavally, Principal (Sree Chithira Thirunal Residential Central school).

A Business Initiative

HLL bags TOLIC Award 2026



Dr. Rajesh Ramakrishnan, VP (HR), HLL Lifecare Ltd., a Mini Ratna Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Govt. of India, receives the national-level TOLIC Award in the Best Category from Anshuli Arya, IAS, Secretary (Official Language), Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, in recognition of the commendable work carried out in the implementation of the Official Language Policy during 2025–26. On the occasion, Dr. Suresh Kumar R., Senior Manager (Official Language), HLL., received the citation for effective implementation and promotion of the official language.

Ananthapuri Hospitals expands CDC



Ananthapuri Hospitals and Research Institute chairman and managing director Dr. A. Marthanda Pillai inaugurating the new, state-of-the-art Child Development Centre (CDC) facility in the presence of hospital directors Rajesh P.N., Dr. Anand Marthanda Pillai, and Dr. Kamala.

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LOST: CLASS 12 ISC Marksheet, Pass Cert, TC & Migration of Mohammed Fayad. ID:18843042>Contact: 8098837917.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, V C Annamma, W/o Late No 9203758 Ex Sep Varughese N I, Resident of Neriyaatti, Chennerkara PO, Kozhenchery Taluk, Pathanamthitta District, Kerala State PIN 689503, have changed my name from V C Annamma to Annamma Varghese

CHANGE OF NAME

I, VIJAYAMMA S NAIR (existing name) spouse of Sivadasan Nair G, presently residing at Kokkanayil Jisha Bhavan, Kottangal, PO Padimom, Mallappally, Dist-Pathanamthitta, State - Kerala Pin-689587, India have changed my name from VIJAYAMMA S NAIR to VIJAYAMMA SIVADASAN NAIR vide affidavit dated 11.09.2026 before the Judicial First-Class Magistrate Thiruvalla.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, SREEJA Widow of Ex.No.15665884 P, Rank: Hav, Name: Jaya Kumar R resident of Theertham, Near Sivan Kovil, Punalur(PO), Kollam, Kerala -691305, have change name from SREEJA to SREEJAMOL R.V vide affidavit dated 15-09-2026 before the Judicial First Class Magistrate-V, kollam.

CHANGE OF NAME & DATE OF BIRTH

I, REMANI J W/o Ex.No.14525233 L Rank:Hav(HNS),Name: Ravindran R resident of Aswathy Bhavanam, Kuthiraparthi(PO), Karunagappally, Kollam, Kerala -690523 have change name from REMANI J to REMANI RAVINDRAN & date of birth from 22 yrs to 11-04-1961 vide affidavit dated 15-09-2026 before the Judicial First Class Magistrate-V, kollam.

THE HINDU

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SITUATION VACANT

GENERAL

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അപേക്ഷ ക്ഷണിക്കുന്നു

വൈദ്യരത്നം ആയുർവ്വേദ കോളേജിൽ നിലവിൽ ഒഴിവുള്ള താഴെ പറയുന്ന അനുവാപക തസ്തികകളിലേയ്ക്ക് യോഗ്യതയുള്ള ഉദ്യോഗാർത്ഥികളിൽ നിന്നും അപേക്ഷകൾ ക്ഷണിച്ചുകൊള്ളുന്നു. ഉദ്യോഗാർത്ഥികൾ വൈദ്യരത്നം ആയുർവ്വേദ കോളേജിന്റെ ഔദ്യോഗിക വെബ്സൈറ്റിൽ പരസ്യപ്പെടുത്തിയ അപേക്ഷ ഫോറത്തിൽ ആയിരിക്കണം അപേക്ഷിക്കേണ്ടത്.

- 1) നേഴ്സ്സ്റ്റേഡ് II (ഒഴിവ്: 01)
- 2) ജൂനിയർ പബ്ലിക് ഹെൽത്ത് നേഴ്സ് (ഒഴിവ്: 01)

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PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Saramma Chacko, spouse of Ex CPL Michael Kochukunju Chacko resident of 1601, Lake Bluff, Garland Texas 75043, USA, have changed my name from Saramma Chacko to Sarah Chacko and D.O.B. 12.05.1950 to 09.11.1946. Affidavit GRN KL026794123202627E dated 08.09.2026. Before Judicial 1<sup>st</sup> Class Magistrate, Thiruvalla.

TENDERS

QUOTATION NOTICE

Sealed quotations are invited for the establishment of a Cloud-based Moodle Learning Management System (LMS) for two years.

For more details visit www.vtmnsscollege.ac.in Last date for submission: 30.09.2026, 3.00 pm. For more details contact Office of the Principal during working hours. Phone No. 0471-2232240. 15.09.2026 Principal V.T.M.N.S.S. College Dhanuvachapuram

**BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION**  
Office of the Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar Division, 2nd Floor, BMP Complex, Dhanvantri Road, Bengaluru-560009

**No.:EE/GNR/Tend/KPPP/014/2026-27 Date:16.09.2026**

**INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT)**  
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The Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar Division, BCCC invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered with CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES or any State Government Organisations for the works detailed in the table below.

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1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> 2) Last Date for submission of tender: **25.09.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.** 3) Opening of technical bid: **28.09.2026 at 12.30 Hrs.** 4) Opening of Financial Bid: **Will be intimated through KPP Portal.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

**Sd/- Executive Engineer, Gandhinagar Division.**

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|--------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 0395   | 5767 | 5842 | 6162 | 6207 | 6784 | 7533 | 8549 | 9119 | 9625 |
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| 0005   | 1464 | 1526 | 1709 | 1793 | 2169 | 2222 | 2310 | 2464 | 2520 | 2666 | 2721 | 2930 |
| 0106   | 3350 | 3155 | 3163 | 3265 | 3322 | 3396 | 3467 | 3571 | 3639 | 3684 | 3704 | 3712 |
| 0374   | 3718 | 3839 | 4010 | 4126 | 4307 | 4804 | 5091 | 5584 | 5806 | 5911 | 5919 | 6055 |
| 0525   | 6095 | 6205 | 6582 | 6625 | 6794 | 7113 | 7285 | 7293 | 7322 | 7457 | 7574 | 7609 |
| 0563   | 7645 | 7746 | 7823 | 7829 | 7836 | 7870 | 8232 | 8768 | 8793 | 8802 | 8826 | 9122 |
| 0566   | 9225 | 9259 | 9380 | 9380 | 9580 | 9651 | 9663 |      |      |      |      |      |

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| തസ്തിക | 0033 | 0085 | 0120 | 0193 | 0636 | 0682 | 1013 | 1233 | 1256 | 1447 | 1542 |
|--------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 0033   | 1551 | 1708 | 2092 | 2139 | 2289 | 2336 | 2547 | 2635 | 2657 | 2707 | 2800 |
| 0085   | 2965 | 2971 | 3007 | 3105 | 3251 | 3284 | 3370 | 3372 | 3419 | 3563 | 3606 |
| 0120   | 3817 | 3977 | 4081 | 4202 | 4218 | 4421 | 4436 | 4563 | 4647 | 4702 | 4775 |
| 0193   | 4817 | 4896 | 5009 | 5040 | 5068 | 5113 | 5175 | 5188 | 5227 | 5247 | 5295 |
| 0636   | 5340 | 5346 | 5370 | 5460 | 5553 | 5603 | 6074 | 6107 | 6153 | 6195 | 6197 |
| 0682   | 6245 | 6275 | 6309 | 6366 | 6382 | 6413 | 6502 | 6998 | 7014 | 7187 | 7189 |
| 0636   | 7296 | 7416 | 7531 | 7641 | 7827 | 7900 | 7933 | 8287 | 8408 | 8409 | 8548 |
| 0682   | 8577 | 8837 | 9241 | 9248 | 9265 | 9489 | 9580 | 9674 |      |      |      |

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| തസ്തിക | 0042 | 0110 | 0216 | 0261 | 0318 | 0338 | 0391 | 0407 | 0449 | 0660 | 0749 | 0760 |
|--------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| 0042   | 0854 | 0864 | 0866 | 1088 | 1112 | 1129 | 1200 | 1270 | 1294 | 1544 | 1609 | 1630 |
| 0110   | 1648 | 1688 | 1722 | 1751 | 1789 | 1854 | 1896 | 1926 | 1984 | 2205 | 2281 | 2317 |
| 0216   | 2326 | 2456 | 2486 | 2497 | 2519 | 2561 | 2632 | 2683 | 2722 | 2741 | 2758 | 2773 |
| 0261   | 2802 | 2831 | 3031 | 3113 | 3151 | 3281 | 3340 | 3473 | 3506 | 3703 | 3860 | 4186 |
| 0318   | 4206 | 4440 | 4492 | 4507 | 4552 | 4626 | 4671 | 4931 | 5257 | 5284 | 5332 | 5338 |
| 0391   | 5383 | 5478 | 5500 | 5589 | 5791 | 6067 | 6128 | 6129 | 6208 | 6328 | 6414 | 6437 |
| 0407   | 6456 | 6478 | 6486 | 6507 | 6555 | 6641 | 6709 | 6711 | 6863 | 6956 | 6981 | 7007 |
| 0449   | 7104 | 7132 | 7366 | 7389 | 7453 | 7515 | 7590 | 7749 | 7791 | 7794 | 7830 | 7965 |
| 0660   | 7973 | 7985 | 8133 | 8134 | 8180 | 8202 | 8297 | 8421 | 8452 | 8521 | 8543 | 8581 |
| 0749   | 8621 | 8631 | 8726 | 8782 | 8938 | 8992 | 9007 | 9013 | 9055 | 9245 | 9373 | 9483 |
| 0760   | 9543 | 9636 | 9739 | 9836 | 9883 | 9890 |      |      |      |      |      |      |

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# CM wants zoo out of city, citizens differ

## Plea to expedite land acquisition

# State set to become investment economy soon, says Satheesan

# Basheer death case: court defers decision on resuming trial

ADVERTISEMENT

## When Urination Changes with Age: What Every Man Should Know



Telangana CM  
urges SC to  
quash FIR on  
'cash for vote'

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**  
NEW DELHI

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Wednesday sought the quashing of the first information report in a 2015 cash-for-vote case, arguing in the Supreme Court that the pre-amendment version of the Prevention of Corruption (PC) Act had not considered the alleged offering of a bribe an offence at all.

Appearing before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocate Siddharth Luthra argued that Section 12, which covered abetment of offences under the PC Act, only pertained to the bribe-taker.

It was only after amendments to the Act in 2018 that offering a bribe to a public servant was made an offence. "This is a pure issue of law," Mr. Luthra submitted.

2015 case

Mr. Revanth, the then Deputy Floor Leader of the Telugu Desam Party, was allegedly caught on camera, offering ₹50 lakh as part of a ₹5-crore "payment". It was alleged to be a "token gesture" to secure the vote of the Anglo-Indian nominee, Elvis Stephenson, for a TDP candidate ahead of the State Legislative Council elections.

Mr. Luthra submitted that the charge under Section 12 was not made out, as an MLA voting in MLC polls under Article 171 of the Constitution was not an 'official act' under the anti-corruption statute.

Dadasaheb Phalke honour for  
Kannada film artist Anant Nag

Actor dedicates award to Kannadigas and Karnataka; recognition comes a year after he was awarded Padma Bhushan; Since his 1973 debut, Nag has acted in over 300 films, spanning mainstream and parallel cinema, in his five-decade career

**The Hindu Bureau**  
BENGALURU

In a big honour for Kannada cinema, veteran actor Anant Nag became the second artist from the State to win the Dadasaheb Phalke Award on Wednesday. The recognition comes a year after the actor was given the Padma Bhushan.

After Dr. Rajkumar received the honour in 1995, no Kannada actor had bagged the country's highest award in the field of cinema.

Mr. Nag, who debuted with the 1973 Kannada film *Sankalpa*, has acted in more than 300 movies for over five decades in both mainstream and parallel cinema, with more than 250 of his performances being in Kannada.



**Unparalleled range:** Anant Nag is the recipient of five State Awards, including the Lifetime Achievement honour. FILE PHOTO

The actor, born Anant Nagarkatte in 1948 in Uttara Kannada district, began his acting stint with Kannada, Marathi, Hindi and Konkani plays. He has a rich background in theatre shaped largely in Mumbai.

Mr. Nag is the recipient of five Karnataka State Awards, including the Life-

time Achievement honour.

He will receive the Phalke award at the 72nd National Film Awards Ceremony on September 22 in Kevadia, Gujarat.

"It's a great feeling to receive this honour. In a way, I feel the Padma Bhushan was a rehearsal for this big award, with all the excite-

ment and anticipation that came with it. I dedicate this award to Kannadigas and Karnataka," the actor told presspersons here.

'Illustrious journey'

A statement from the Press Information Bureau read, "On the recommendation of the Dadasaheb Phalke Award Selection Committee, the Government of India is pleased to announce that the actor will be conferred the prestigious Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024 for his contribution to Indian cinema and an illustrious cinematic journey that has inspired generations."

Prime Minister Narendra Modi congratulated the actor for "infusing unparalleled performance and vitality in every role he played". Mr. Modi took to

social media and said, "Over the past several decades, his natural acting, remarkable versatility, and exceptional artistic talent have left an indelible mark on Indian cinema, particularly in the Kannada film industry."

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar also commended Mr. Nag's cinematic journey and the Phalke award. "Heartfelt congratulations to Shri Anant Nag. His artistic journey will forever inspire future generations," Mr. Shivakumar said in a post on X.

Though cinematographer V.K. Murthy from Karnataka received the award in 2008, it was for his work in Hindi cinema.

Mr. Nag's win marks the second time Kannada cinema has been honoured.

Revanth lists extent of land owned by KCR, family

**M. Rajeev**  
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has alleged that Bharat Rashtira Samithi (BRS) president and former Chief Minister K. Chandrashekhara Rao and his family members amassed hundreds of acres of land in the name of agitation for Telangana Statehood, and after the party came to power in 2014.

As per the list released by the Chief Minister in the Assembly on Wednesday, Mr. Rao and his wife own 67.13 acres of land at Erravalli, Mittapalli and Shivar Venkatapur villages in Siddipet district in violation of the land ceiling Act.

BRS working president and MLA K.T. Rama Rao possesses 123.19 acres in villages in Siddipet and Rangareddy districts, while KCR's daughter Kavi-



Revanth Reddy

ta and her husband own 37.26 acres. Another family member and BRS deputy floor leader T. Harish Rao

and his wife possess 30.16 acres. Another member, Joginapalli Santosh Kumar, and family own 79.2 acres. Mr. Rao's relative Naveen Kumar owns 101.14 acres in Medchal-Malkajgiri, Rangareddy, Sangareddy and Siddipet districts. This takes the total land assets of the family to 439.3 acres spread over nine districts, 24 mandals and 31 villages.

"We have seen people agitating for a cause losing

everything. But one family benefited immensely in the name of Statehood agitation," he said, adding that he was not counting the assets in the name of benamis. Mr. Reddy said the Erravalli farmhouse where Mr. Rao stays, spans over 700 acres. Of this, 388 acres is assignment land (government land given to farmers for cultivation). "My government will inquire into it," he said.

CCB searches four locations in  
T.N. linked to former DMK Minister

**The Hindu Bureau**  
TIRUCHI/CHENNAI

A team from the Central Crime Branch (CCB) of the Chennai City Police conducted simultaneous searches at four locations in Tiruchi and Chennai linked to former DMK Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, including his residence in Tiruchi, on Wednesday.

The searches were in connection with a case registered against Mr. Poyyamozhi under the Prevention of Corruption Act in an alleged multi-crore fraud involving private schools.

The police alleged that the searches were conducted after it came to light, during investigations by the CCB, that Mr. Poyyamozhi had engaged in corruption and committed a breach of trust in the multi-



Police personnel stationed outside former Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi's residence in Tiruchi during the search operation by the Central Crime Branch on Wednesday. R. VENGADESH

crore fraud, when he was the School Education Minister during the previous DMK regime. Searches were also conducted at two places in Tiruchi and Chennai linked to the former Minister's aide, Valadi Karthik.

The CCB had previously arrested B.T. Arasakumar, 59, of Saligramam in Chen-

nai in June this year on charges of collecting large sums of money from private school managements for upgrading schools, gaining permanent recognition, securing building plan approvals, and subsequently cheating them.

He was arrested by the CCB on the basis of a complaint lodged by Ilangovan,

secretary, Federation of Associations of Private Schools in Tamil Nadu, with the Chennai City Commissioner of Police. Arasakumar was later detained under the Goondas Act. Two more persons were arrested in connection with the same case and remanded in judicial custody.

Bank accounts frozen

Bank accounts of persons against whom the charges had been levelled, and those of their family members, were frozen in connection with the alleged fraud, after receiving a series of complaints.

DMK president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin termed the police searches at the houses of Mr. Poyyamozhi an act of political vendetta and a diversionary tactic of the TVK-led government.

**Timings**  
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

**THURSDAY, SEP. 17**  
RISE 06:12 SET 18:21  
RISE 11:10 SET 22:58

**FRIDAY, SEP. 18**  
RISE 06:12 SET 18:20  
RISE 12:02 SET 23:49

**SATURDAY, SEP. 19**  
RISE 06:12 SET 18:20  
RISE 12:53 SET 00:00

**Thiruvananthapuram Weather** max min  
Attingal 34 25  
Nedumangad 34 25  
Thiruvananthapuram 34 25

**Thiruvananthapuram Today**  
33°C The weather will be warm. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur. Night will be comfortable.

**Thiruvananthapuram Tomorrow**  
34°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be warm. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower to occur.

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**KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD**  
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)  
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar,  
Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, website: www.kiadb.in

**No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-DPR-03/764/2026-27** **Date: 16.09.2026**  
**SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER**  
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB invites tender from reputed consultants/firms under two cover bid system with vast experience and proven record of similar nature of work for project mentioned below:-

**Name of the work:** 1) Providing Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) Preparation of Economic Analysis, Feasibility Report, Surveying, Layout Plan Design, Preparation of Cost Estimates, Cost Structure etc., for the Formation of PM-Mitra Textile Park at Kalaburgi. (Extent 1000 Acres). 2) Providing Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the Formation of Housing Layout at Narendra-Mummugatti Industrial Area, Dharwad Taluk & District. (Extent 111 Acres).

The last date and time for Submission of bids : **29.09.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/-

**Chief Engineer -2 KIADB, Bengaluru**

DIPR/CP/2776/NR/2026-27

**THE HINDU**  
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM  
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**PMU - ENTERPRISE DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROGRAMME**  
TRAVANCORE DEVASWOM BOARD  
EOI Reference No.: PMU/TDB/DIG/EOI/2026/01  
Dated: 17/09/2026  
**EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)**  
FOR EMPANELMENT OF IT COMPANIES, STARTUPS & MSMEs FOR RESOURCE AUGMENTATION  
The PMU of the TDB invites EOIs from eligible and competent IT companies, startups & MSMEs for empanelment towards the supply of technical human resources for Enterprise Digital Transformation Programme. EOI Document can be downloaded from [www.cmd.kerala.gov.in](http://www.cmd.kerala.gov.in).  
Last date for submission of EOI: **September 30, 2026, 3.00 PM**  
SD/- Special Officer

**TNPPL TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED**  
Kagithapuram - 639 136. Karur Dist. Tamil Nadu.  
**NOTICE INVITING TENDER**  

| Tender No.       | Material Description                    | Due date   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| 262713<br>003891 | Procurement of Fuel Oil for Unit-I & II | 24.09.2026 |

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPPL Website and NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & conditions are available in tender document at our websites : [www.tnppl.com](http://www.tnppl.com) / <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>  
DIPR/2861/Tender/2026 **TNPPL - Maker of bagasse based eco-friendly Paper**

**SPECIALIZED ASSET RECOVERY MANAGEMENT BRANCH**  
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM  
Third Floor, Canara Bank Circle Office Building, TC 26/173 (1), MG Road, Spencer Junction, Trivandrum- 695001, Phone: 0471-2324797, 9037756600. E-mail: cb7909@canarabank.com

**SALE NOTICE**  
E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Properties under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002  
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable properties mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the constructive Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of Canara Bank will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" on below mentioned date for recovery of below mentioned outstanding amounts with further interest and suit expenses/other legal charges if any, costs, other charges and expenses thereon to the Canara Bank from below mentioned Borrowers & Guarantors.

Name and address of the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s): 1) M/S S B Enterprises, Represented by its Proprietor Mr Sreekumar Nair K, TC 25/2010 (2), 1st Floor, Ultradam Building, Desabhimani Road, Gandhari Amman Kovil Jn, Thampanoor, Trivandrum -695001, 2) Mr Sreekumar Nair K, Residing At Sreelaksh, TC 55/435 1, E-8 Amritha Nagar, Kaimanam, Pappanamcode P O, Trivandrum -695018, 3) Mrs Sreelatha S, residing at Sreelaksh, TC 55/435 1, E-8 Amritha Nagar, Kaimanam, Pappanamcode P O, Trivandrum-695018, 4) Mr Karun Chandran B and 5) Mr. Murali, both residing at TC 25/2010 (2), Ultradam Building, Desabhimani Road, Gandhari Amman Kovil Jn, Trivandrum , Kerala -695001.

Total liabilities : Rs 4,26,30,000/- (Rupees Four Crores Twenty Six Lakhs Thirty Thousand Only) as on 09.07.2026 plus further interest along with suit expenses and other legal charges

**Details of Properties:** Property 1: All that part and parcel of 4.19 ares (10.35 cents) of property and 3500 Sq Ft residential cum commercial building "Ultradam Building" No: TC 81/141 and all other things comprised in Re Sy No:71, in Block No:87 of Vanchiyoor village, Thiruvananthapuram Taluk, Thiruvananthapuram District in the name of Mr Karun Chandran B. Boundaries as per deed : East: Corporation Road (Manjalikulam Road); West: Deepam Flat; North: Sukumar Builders; South: Private Pathway.

**Reserve price : Rs.3,75,00,000/- EMD:Rs.37,50,000/-**

Property 2: All that part and parcel of 5 cents (2.05 Ares) of property and 2700 SqFt residential building in Re Sy No 34/13 Block No. 26 of Neerom Village Thiruvananthapuram Taluk, Thiruvananthapuram District in the name of Mrs Sreekumar Nair Boundaries: East: Property of Sreedharan; West: Property of Madhusoodanan; North: Corporation Road; South: Property of Hemalatha

**Reserve price: Rs.1,00,00,000/- EMD: Rs.10,00,000/-**  
**Date & Time of E-Auction: 06:10-2026, between 11.30 am and 12.30 pm (with unlimited extension of 5 minutes duration each till sale is concluded)**  
**The Earnest Money Deposit shall be deposited on or before 05.10.2026, 5.00 PM**  
The Property can be inspected Date & Time: On or before 05.10.2026 between 10.00 am and 5.00 pm  
For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer the link "E-Auction" provided in Canara Bank's website ([www.canarabank.com](http://www.canarabank.com)) or service provider M/s PSB Alliance Pvt Ltd (baanknet). E-mail id: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com, Phone: 8291220220 or may contact Chief Manager of the Specialized Asset Recovery Management Branch, Trivandrum, Third Floor, Canara Bank Circle Office Building, TC 26/173 (1), MG Road, Spencer Junction, Trivandrum-695001. Phone: 0471-2324797, 9037756600, e-mail: cb7909@canarabank.com during office hours on any working day.

**Portal of E-Auction: <https://baanknet.com>**  
**Date: 14-09-2026, Place: Trivandrum (Sd/-) Authorised Officer, Canara Bank**

**WEATHERWATCH**  
Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday

TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

**Forecast for Thursday:** Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Sikkim, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Delhi, Jharkhand, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Lakshadweep

| CITY        | RAIN  | MAX  | MIN   | CITY | RAIN               | MAX   | MIN        |       |      |       |      |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|------|--------------------|-------|------------|-------|------|-------|------|
| Agartala    | ..... | 32.5 | ..... | 26.6 | Kurnool            | ..... | 38.3       | ..... | 28.0 |       |      |
| Ahmedabad   | ..... | 1.2  | ..... | 32.6 | .....              | 24.9  | Lucknow    | ..... | 34.6 | ..... | 26.4 |
| Aizawl      | ..... | 6.4  | ..... | 32.0 | .....              | 21.0  | Madurai    | ..... | 36.4 | ..... | 24.7 |
| Bengaluru   | ..... | 55.8 | ..... | 31.1 | .....              | 19.0  | Mangaluru  | ..... | 32.3 | ..... | 24.6 |
| Bhopal      | ..... | 32.4 | ..... | 22.8 | Mumbai             | ..... | 15.5       | ..... | 31.5 | ..... | 25.3 |
| Bhubaneswar | ..... | 34.0 | ..... | 25.6 | Mysuru             | ..... | 19         | ..... | 33.0 | ..... | 20.0 |
| Chandigarh  | ..... | 35.0 | ..... | 21.6 | New Delhi          | ..... | 36.8       | ..... | 26.8 |       |      |
| Chennai     | ..... | 37.0 | ..... | 27.8 | Patna              | ..... | 0.3        | ..... | 34.5 | ..... | 27.8 |
| Coimbatore  | ..... | 0.3  | ..... | 35.0 | .....              | 23.2  | Port Blair | ..... | 29.9 | ..... | 24.8 |
| Dehradun    | ..... | 1    | ..... | 32.6 | .....              | 21.2  | Prayagraj  | ..... | 11   | ..... | 27.2 |
| Gangtok     | ..... | 7.6  | ..... | 19.1 | .....              | 17.2  | Puducherry | ..... | 34.3 | ..... | 26.6 |
| Goa         | ..... | 0.2  | ..... | 32.6 | .....              | 24.5  | Pune       | ..... | 31.3 | ..... | 23.1 |
| Guwahati    | ..... | 33.4 | ..... | 25.9 | Raipur             | ..... | 33.4       | ..... | 26.2 |       |      |
| Hubbali     | ..... | 31.0 | ..... | 22.0 | Ranchi             | ..... | 18         | ..... | 31.1 | ..... | 22.0 |
| Hyderabad   | ..... | 34.0 | ..... | 24.0 | Shillong           | ..... | 1          | ..... | 26.0 | ..... | 16.6 |
| Imphal      | ..... | 30.7 | ..... | 21.5 | Shimla             | ..... | 6          | ..... | 24.0 | ..... | 14.8 |
| Jaipur      | ..... | 34.6 | ..... | 25.2 | Srinagar           | ..... | 30.2       | ..... | 12.9 |       |      |
| Kochi       | ..... | 32.0 | ..... | 26.6 | Thiruvananthapuram | ..... | 35.4       | ..... | 25.2 |       |      |
| Kohima      | ..... | 24.0 | ..... | 18.0 | Tiruchirappalli    | ..... | 38.3       | ..... | 26.0 |       |      |
| Kolkata     | ..... | 36.5 | ..... | 27.2 | Vijayawada         | ..... | 35.4       | ..... | 27.0 |       |      |
| Kozhikode   | ..... | 35.1 | ..... | 26.3 | Visakhapatnam      | ..... | 33.4       | ..... | 26.4 |       |      |

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

**Pollutants in the air you are breathing**

| CITIES        | SO <sub>2</sub> | NO <sub>2</sub> | CO    | PM <sub>2.5</sub> | PM <sub>10</sub> | CODE | Yesterday |     |       |     |   |                                                              |
|---------------|-----------------|-----------------|-------|-------------------|------------------|------|-----------|-----|-------|-----|---|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ahmedabad     | .....           | 28              | ..... | 29                | .....            | 62   | .....     | 47  | ..... | 93  | ■ | In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Leh, Ladakh                |
| Bengaluru     | .....           | 21              | ..... | 17                | .....            | 44   | .....     | 91  | ..... | 95  | ■ | recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of         |
| Chennai       | .....           | 7               | ..... | 11                | .....            | 43   | .....     | 115 | ..... | 159 | ■ | 300 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, |
| Delhi         | .....           | 19              | ..... | 44                | .....            | 30   | .....     | 89  | ..... | 159 | ■ | Madikeri, Karnataka                                          |
| Hyderabad     | .....           | 13              | ..... | 15                | .....            | 47   | .....     | 72  | ..... | 70  | ■ | recorded a healthy AQI score of 17                           |
| Kolkata       | .....           | 9               | ..... | 44                | .....            | 35   | .....     | 61  | ..... | 90  | ■ |                                                              |
| Mumbai        | .....           | 6               | ..... | 31                | .....            | 33   | .....     | 68  | ..... | 77  | ■ |                                                              |
| Pune          | .....           | 5               | ..... | 115               | .....            | 18   | .....     | 11  | ..... | 15  | ■ |                                                              |
| Visakhapatnam | .....           | 13              | ..... | 72                | .....            | 17   | .....     | 62  | ..... | 67  | ■ |                                                              |

**Air Quality Code:** ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

**SO<sub>2</sub>:** Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

**NO<sub>2</sub>:** Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

**CO:** Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

**PM<sub>2.5</sub> & PM<sub>10</sub>:** Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

**INSTITUTE FOR SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC CHANGE**  
Dr. V.K.R.V. Rao Road, Nagarabhavi, Bangalore - 560 072, India

**NOMINATIONS INVITED – PROF. M. N. SRINIVAS CHAIR PROFESSOR, 2026–27**  
ISEC invites nominations from distinguished scholars of national/international repute in Sociology, Social Anthropology and related Social Sciences for the **Prof. M. N. Srinivas Chair Professor** for six months during January–December 2027.  
**Honorarium: ₹ 2,00,000/- per month.** Nominations may be sent to The Director, ISEC, Bengaluru – 560072 | [director@isec.ac.in](mailto:director@isec.ac.in) by **16th October 2026**. For detailed notification and guidelines, visit [www.isec.ac.in](http://www.isec.ac.in).  
sd/-  
Director, ISEC

DIPR/CP/2771/Shirdi Sai/2026-27

**Tamil Nadu Police Housing Corporation Ltd.**  
(A Government of Tamil Nadu Undertaking)  
(AN ISO 9001 : 2015 CERTIFIED COMPANY)  
South Circle,  
No.1 Inspector Quarters, TSP 6<sup>th</sup> Battalion Campus,  
New Attaram Road, Medurairi - 625 014,  
email id: [secrndutpohcl@gmail.com](mailto:secrndutpohcl@gmail.com) Phone: 0452- 2903019

**e-tender Invitation for Bids No: 11/2026-2027 Dated: 11.09.2026**

| Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                     | Approximate value of work in Lakhs (2025-2026) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1) Construction of 70 Nos. of Individual Houses [6 DSP (Type-1), 20 INS/Sl (Type-2) and 44 PC/H/C (Type-3) under "OWN YOUR HOUSE" Scheme at KODUVILARPATTI VILLAGE in Theni District (Phase-II)] | ₹ 1696.96 + GST @ 18%                          |

1) For Tender document, visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>  
2) Date and Time for downloading and submission the tender documents : **06.10.2026 from 12.00 Noon to 04.11.2026 upto 06.00 P.M**  
3) Date and time of opening of the e-tender : **06.11.2026 at 11.15 A.M**  
4) Detailed Tender Notice available in the website [www.tnphc.com](http://www.tnphc.com) & [www.tnpolice.gov.in](http://www.tnpolice.gov.in)

**Superintending Engineer, South Circle, TNPHC Ltd**

DIPR/2855/Tender/2026

**KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED**  
(RAICHUR THERMAL POWER STATION)  
CIN : U85110KA1970SGC001919

**BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION (TWO TENDER SYSTEM) (Through e-procurement portal only)**

E-Tenders are invited through Gok e-procurement portal (Website URL: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>) for the following Procurements.

**1) KPCL/2026-27/PM/WORK\_INDENT 4465/CALL-3 Dtd: 11.09.2026**  
Supply, Repair and Replacement of worn-out/damaged SS liner plates of wagon tippler-5 hopper at CHP-2/RTPS. **Approx. amount put to Tender (Exclusive of GST): Rs.40,96,050/- . EMD: Rs.82,000/-.** Last date for submission of completed tender document up to 17:30 hours on 26.09.2026. Further details can be obtained from the Executive Engineer (CHP)M-2 RTPS, Shakthinagar, Raichur District, Karnataka State-584170. Mobile No.9448290758.

**2) KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK\_INDENT 4788 Date : 11.09.2026.** Retrofitting, Testing and Commissioning of ABB make 12kV,1250A, 40KA, HT Breakers with cradle solution in place of Jyothi make HT Breaker at Control Room SWGR and old HT Breaker of Tacker/Reclaimer-3 at CHP-1 RTPS . **EMD: Rs.49,897/-.** Last date for receipt of tenders: 28.09.2026. Any clarifications may be had from the Office of the Executive Engineer (CHP)E1, RTPS, Shakthinagar, Raichur District, Karnataka State.

**3) KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK\_INDENT4781 Dated. 12/09/2026.** RTPS-Periodical Mechanical maintenance / Overhauling works of various equipment's at Oil handling system (FOPH) 1 & 2 and Oil Decanting Pump House (ODPH) for a period of one year. **EMD: Rs. 189920/-.** Last date for submission of completed tender document up to 16:00 hours on 19.09.2026. Further details of the work can be obtained from the office of the Executive Engineer (CAM-2) RTPS, Shakthinagar-584170 (Mob: 9448248068) during office hours.



## Mining amendment is unfair to States

India's mineral wealth is not evenly spread across the country. States such as Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, and Karnataka possess enormous reserves of coal, iron ore, and other minerals that feed industries across India. While mining brings in investment and employment, it also leaves the host State to deal with challenges such as the resettlement of displaced groups; environmental damage; pressure on public infrastructure; and the long-term consequences of extracting minerals that can never be replaced.

That is why the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act (MMDR), 2026 deserves closer attention. At the heart of the amendment is Section 9D which restricts State Governments from imposing taxes, cesses or other levies on mineral rights or mineral-bearing land except in accordance with conditions prescribed by the Central government. The Centre says the measure is intended to create a predictable tax environment, prevent excessive levies, and to encourage long-term investment in mining. There is an understandable economic argument behind that objective. Mining projects involve enormous investments and operate over decades; investors need to know that the financial rules will not change unpredictably from one year to another. However, this logic has been contested by the States.

The real question is not merely whether States will continue receiving the royalty, the auction premium and other



Ashok Kumar Panda

Senior Advocate



Aniruddha Purushotham

Advocate

revenues they receive today. The Centre claims that 90% of mining sector revenue accrues to the States and that this will continue. The larger concern is about what States may be prevented from earning tomorrow.

A mineral-rich State possesses a natural economic advantage. Ordinarily, one would expect it to have some ability to use that advantage to raise resources for its own development. Section 9D substantially reduces that freedom by making future State levies related to minerals dependent upon a framework controlled by the Centre. This matters enormously for States whose budgets are closely connected with mining. NITI Aayog's Fiscal Health Index has highlighted the strong performance of Odisha and Chhattisgarh in mobilising revenue and has specifically recognised the role played by mining receipts. In Odisha, mining has accounted for a large proportion of the State's non-tax revenue. Mineral producing districts often require greater public expenditure because they bear the costs of mining.

### The federal problem

The constitutional issue is equally significant. The Constitution gives States the power to tax mineral rights under Entry 50 of the State List, although Parliament can impose limitations on that power through laws relating to mineral development. States also possess a separate constitutional power to tax lands and buildings under Entry 49 of the State List.

In 2024, a nine-judge Bench of the Supreme Court in *Mineral Area Development Authority vs. Steel Authority*

*of India* held, among other things, that royalty payable on minerals is not a tax. It also recognised the States' legislative power to tax mineral rights and held that mineral-bearing land can fall within the States' taxation power over land. The 2026 Amendment risks rendering the impact of this judgment nugatory.

While Entry 50 permits Parliament to place limitations upon State taxation on mineral rights, Section 9D of the amending statute goes further by extending its restriction to taxes or levies on mineral-bearing lands. That is likely to raise an important debate: how far can a Central law dealing with mineral development restrict a State's exclusive power to tax land? The issue is larger than mining policy alone. It concerns the relationship between the Union and the States.

India's federal system cannot function effectively if States have responsibilities without financial capacity. A State that bears the infrastructural and social consequences of mineral extraction must retain a meaningful stake in the economic value generated from its natural resources. Uniformity may make taxation more predictable, but predictability should not come at the cost of narrowing the fiscal choices available to States.

The debate over the MMDR Amendment should therefore not be reduced to a contest between promoting investment and imposing taxes. The minerals beneath a State's soil may serve the entire country, but the costs of extracting them are felt most directly by the people who live above them.

## What India's growth really means

India's 7.8% real GDP growth in April to June 2026 is an extension of a strong economic journey – real GDP grew 7.2% in 2023-24, 7.1% in 2024-25, and 7.7% in 2025-26. The latest rate exceeds the RBI's 7% forecast despite the West Asian conflict, high energy prices, and uncertain trade. Its real significance, however, lies in the breadth of production and demand.

Real GDP, which is the value of goods and services after adjusting for inflation, rose to ₹81.36 lakh crore, while real GVA, the value added by farms, factories and services before adjusting for product taxes and subsidies, grew by 8.2% to ₹73.82 lakh crore. Manufacturing rose by 9.2%, utilities 8.9% and construction 7.7%, lifting the secondary sector by 8.6%. Services grew by 10%, led by finance, real estate, IT and professional services at 12.1%. Agriculture grew by 3.6%, although mining contracted by 2.4%. This is broad-based growth with identifiable weak spots.

This strength is reinforced by demand. Gross fixed capital formation grew by 11.9%, private consumption by 7.1% and real exports 12%. Using the same gross fixed capital formation measure for 2023-24, investments by private corporations were 10.3% of GDP. While the general government invested 4.2%, total public sector investment was 7.8% when adding in investments by public corporations. Moreover, when adding in household investments, mainly housing and unincorporated businesses, total non-public investment was 24.1% of GDP. That is, while public capital



Gourav Vallabh

Professor of Finance, XLRI and Part Time Member, Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. Views are personal

expenditure has built the platform, the next acceleration requires more private investment.

### Fast growing economy

The base year change is simple. A base year removes inflation and reflects the economy's structure. Updating it from 2011-12 to 2022-23 replaces an outdated market basket with today's products, services and prices. Some estimates may rise and others fall, but changing the ruler does not shrink the economy. On comparable year-on-year data, India's 7.8% exceeded Malaysia's 6%, Singapore's 5.9%, Indonesia's 5.29%, and China's 4.3%.

India is therefore among the fastest growing major economies. Its expanding market supports global demand for energy, technology, machinery and services, while offering a trusted location for diversified supply chains. This advances India's path to becoming the world's third largest economy in nominal terms. Since rankings also reflect prices and exchange rates, the milestone will endure only if real growth leads to higher productivity, stronger firms, and better household incomes. Employment is the decisive test. India added 17.19 crore jobs between 2014-15 and 2023-24, according to RBI KLEMS-based data. The next employment revolution must improve job quality through productivity, wages, formalisation, social security and skilling. While women's labour force participation reached 41.7% in 2023-24, safe transport, affordable childcare, flexible work, credit and market access are essential to bring many more women into

productive employment.

Manufacturing must move from assembly to design, components, machinery, electronics and clean technology, while services must spread beyond metros into tourism, health, education, logistics, finance and Indian language digital businesses. AI preparedness must move from adoption to original capability through domestic compute, Indian language data, research talent, and trusted applications. India must also make proper use of Free Trade Agreements (FTAs). An FTA utilisation mission should guide firms on rules of tariffs and markets. MSMEs need hand-holding on non-tariff barriers through shared testing, affordable certification, standards, customs support and buyer discovery. Moreover, external ambition requires domestic resilience. India should counter energy risks through diversified suppliers, long term contracts, strategic reserves, renewables, domestic exploration and efficiency. Timely infrastructure, predictable regulation, easier credit, and stable taxation can crowd in private investment.

The 7.8% quarter warrants confidence, not complacency. India must convert public capital expenditure into private investment, job numbers into quality employment, and FTAs into opportunities for MSMEs. If energy and macroeconomic stability accompany inclusion, productivity, and transparent measurement, becoming the third largest economy will be more than a statistical milestone. It will become a foundation for broad-based prosperity.

## SIR deletions: elector numbers in 1/3 of Delhi below poll turnout

The number of electors left in the roll – 94.9 lakh – is 97% of the total number of actual voters who turned up to vote in the 2025 elections

### DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A.  
Devvyanshi Bihani  
Srinivasan Ramani

In more than one third of the 70 constituencies in Delhi, the number of deletions following the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process has been so high that the draft roll in these seats have been left with fewer electors than the actual number of those who voted in the February 2025 Assembly elections.

If one were to trust that the Election Commission (EC) process has been fair, one should believe in the following astounding possibilities: that everyone who has been deemed to be an "ordinary resident" in these 24 constituencies had voted; a significant chunk who voted are no longer there; and that those who did not vote during the 2025 polls were not ordinarily resident then or have ceased to be so in the 17 months between the polls and the commencement of the SIR. In other words, these constituencies witnessed inward and outward migrations of enormous scale in this period alone.

However, there are no signs that any of these things happened. In such a situation, it stands to reason that in merely a year and a half since the Assembly elections, conducted by the EC itself, the changes would not be so dramatic that deletions would entail the electorate to reduce to a number lower than the turnout figures.

Since the draft enumeration process involves electors listing their EPIC numbers and their eligibility to vote in the elections, it stretches reason to assume that the recent voters deemed themselves as ineligible.

This is just the draft roll, and there is still time for electors to be added to the lists – both freshly eligible ones and others who have been erroneously deleted from the rolls. But the slapdash nature of

the SIR process is evident in the fact that the Union Territory has now been left with only 97.5 lakh electors in the draft roll.

### Evidence from elections

In February 2025, the electoral rolls had 1.56 crore electors, of which 94.9 lakh electors turned out to vote.

This number in the draft rolls follows two stages of culling names – one prior to the SIR when close to 11 lakh electors were deleted and later, the draft SIR phase when nearly 47.6 lakh electors were deleted (Chart 1).

The Tughlakabad constituency is where the SIR process has made the deepest cut in these terms. In the current draft rolls, there are only 1,00,386 electors, which is 14,575 fewer than the 1,14,961 voters who actually turned out to vote in 2025.

Chart 3 lists 15 of the 24 constituencies in Delhi which have fewer electors now than the actual turnout in 2025. This oddity is most pronounced in the eastern, central and southern parts of Delhi; highest especially in seats beyond the Yamuna river on the east.

The number of electors left in the roll – 94.9 lakh – is 97% of the total number of actual voters who turned up to vote in the 2025 elections with just a "buffer" of around 2.6 lakh electors to leave room for those who were ordinary residents, but did not turn out to vote.

In other words, if all the deletions since the Assembly polls are legitimate, based on the draft rolls, now, the hypothetical turnout percentage would be an implausible 97% (Chart 2).

Interestingly this pattern of leaving a small "buffer" of electors is more marked for States and UTs who have undergone the SIR in Phase 3 – Andhra Pradesh (8.8%), Karnataka (13.1%), Maharashtra (16.2%) and so on. In other words, as the SIR went from phase to phase, the pattern of deletions left fewer "buffer" electors, with Delhi being the "worst" case.

## Numbers that do not add up

The data for the charts were sourced from publicly available information on the websites of the Election Commission of India. For Chart 2, turnout figures of 2024 LS polls or Assembly elections in respective States / UTs, whichever happened closer to SIR, were taken for analysis



CHART 1: Of the 1.56 crore electors who were on the rolls before the Delhi Assembly polls in February 2025, 94.9 lakh had voted. Since then, over 58.5 lakh names have been removed

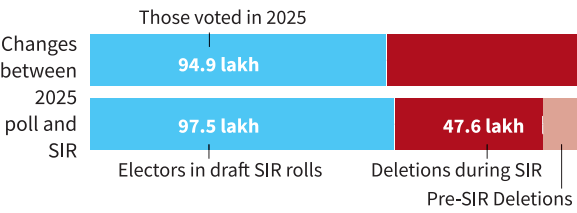
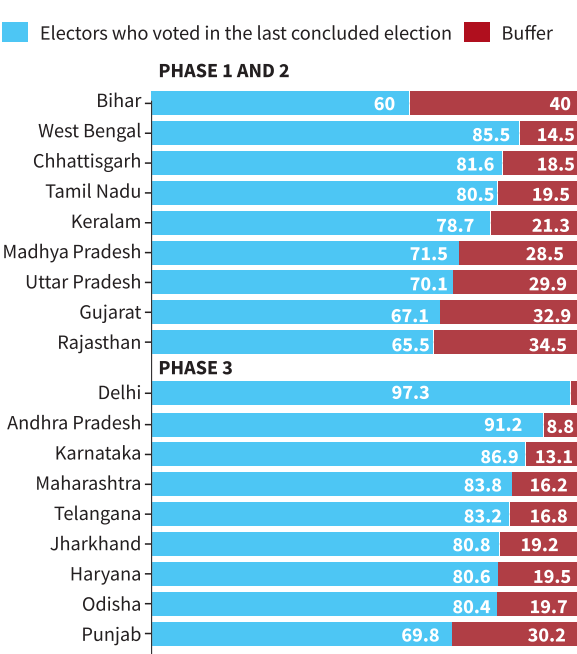
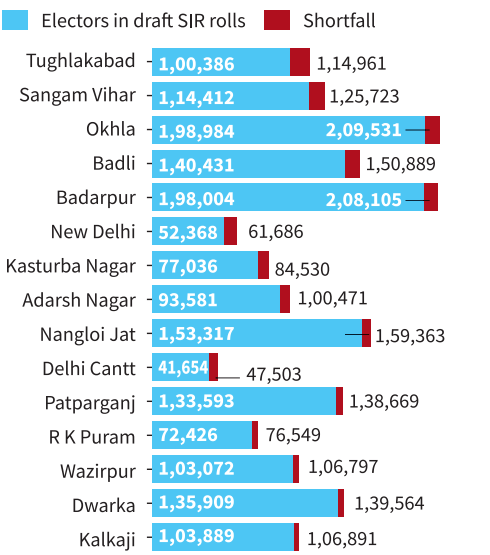


CHART 2: The share of those who voted in the elections before SIR, compared with the electors in the draft SIR rolls. The "buffer" has shrunk noticeably in Phase 3 of the SIR

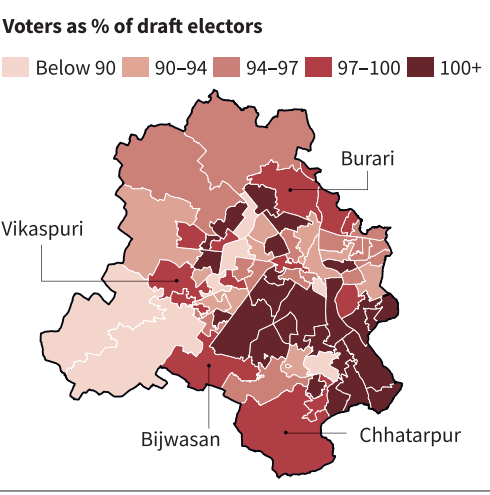


'Buffer' indicates the share of draft SIR rolls which includes eligible electors who did not vote in the last election, but continue to remain ordinary residents of the respective places. A narrow buffer of 2.6% in Delhi indicates high possibility of aggressive deletions and potential disenfranchisement of eligible voters

CHART 3: The 15 constituencies with the highest shortfall in the draft SIR rolls when compared with actual voters (shown outside the bars) in the 2025 polls



MAP 1: This shows those voted in 2025 as a share of electors in draft SIR rolls. 100% or more means those ACs have fewer electors than those who voted in 2025



### FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 17, 1976

## Calicut customs hunt for hidden gold

Calicut, September 16: The Calicut customs are trying to unearth gold biscuits worth lakhs of rupees suspected to have been hidden in a big tank in the midst of paddy fields at Poyilkavu, near Quilandy, for the last 20 years. A bund has been built across the tank and water is being pumped out to night and the authorities hope to strike pay dirt to-morrow evening.

Mr. Dayasankar Karanth, Assistant Collector of Customs, who is in charge of the operation, said that in 1956 the customs had made a big haul of smuggled gold biscuits from the Kaapiad shore (the famous coastal point where Vasco da Gama landed) worth about Rs. 20 lakhs then. It was a big catch and came to be known as "Kaipad seizure." The gold biscuits, in cloth jackets, had been tied to rocks under seawater about a furlong from the shore. Intelligence reports since then had indicated that part of this smuggled gold had already been removed to shore before the customs men got scent of it and been dumped into the tank.

About six months ago, according to a report, a group of nearly dozen men tried to dig this gold out from the tank without the knowledge of the owner of the tank. On the first night they almost succeeded but the appearance of a snake terrified them and put them off. The next night also they made a secret attempt with the help of a 'manthravadi' to scare the snake away but they met with no success.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 17, 1926

## Mystery of magnetism

Calcutta, September 17: An interesting discovery, which promises to throw light on the mystery of magnetism and its relation to Chemistry has been made by Professor C.V. Raman, F.R.S, and his associates in the research in Calcutta. By using highly sensitive refined optical methods, it has been demonstrated that molecules of all common liquids, or paraffin for instance, when placed in a strong magnetic field, orientats and tend to place themselves, so that certain favoured directions are parallel to the field. Investigation shows every molecule in its liquid state to possess different magnetic properties in different directions and actually enables these differences to be measured and connected with the chemical structure of molecules.



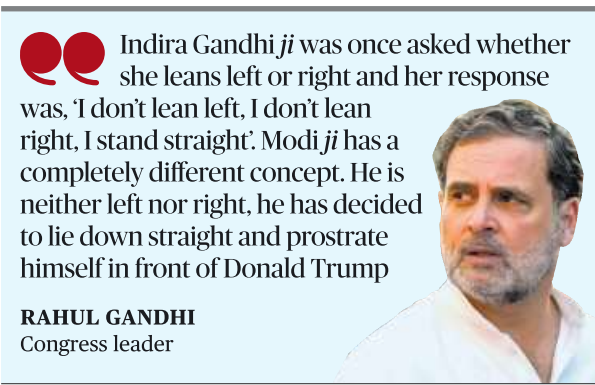
# PM decided to prostrate before Trump, says Rahul on UPI fee

Modi govt. gave in to U.S. demand to get rid of zero MDR for UPI, says Jairam, questions if move intends to benefit U.S. card companies; Kharge terms U.S. threat of higher tariffs on countries buying oil from Russia a failure of India's foreign policy

**The Hindu Bureau**  
NEW DELHI

Mounting a sharp attack on the Narendra Modi government over the introduction of a charge on certain UPI transactions, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday accused the Prime Minister of “prostrating” before U.S. President Donald Trump, and demanded an immediate rollback of the decision.

In a video posted on X, Mr. Gandhi said Mr. Modi had “decided to lie down straight and prostrate himself in front of Donald Trump”, and accused the government of imposing a “UPI tax” on Indians to give “a huge amount of money” to the United States.



“Indira Gandhiji was once asked whether she leans left or right and her response was, ‘I don’t lean left, I don’t lean right, I stand straight.’ Modiji has a completely different concept. He is neither left nor right, he has decided to lie down straight and prostrate himself in front of Donald Trump,” Mr. Gandhi said. “Modiji, stop lying down in front of the U.S.,

have a spine, stand up and rollback the UPI tax,” Mr. Gandhi added.

The Congress has sought to link the UPI decision to what it describes as growing U.S. pressure on India, including demands for changes to the zero merchant discount rate (MDR) regime for UPI. The party has also stepped up its attack following moves in the U.S. Congress to im-

pose tariffs on countries buying oil and gas from Russia.

Congress general secretary in charge of communications Jairam Ramesh said the U.S. Trade Representative had earlier criticised UPI for being free and for having displaced card companies such as Visa and Mastercard.

“Here, the Modi government has given in to a U.S. demand to get rid of zero MDR and charge for UPI,” Mr. Ramesh said, questioning why the rate had been fixed at 0.4% and whether the move was intended to enable U.S. card companies to compete with UPI.

“The PM has redefined NOTA – Narendra’s Ongoing Trump Appeasement,” he said.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, reacting to the U.S. tariff legislation,

said the threat of higher tariffs showed that the government’s foreign and trade policies had “miserably failed”.

“From tariffs and trade to H1B1 immigration, visas and digital payments, the pressure from Washington keeps mounting, and you, ‘Howdy Modiji!’ keep surrendering!” Mr. Kharge said on X.

Earlier, Congress media and publicity department head Pawan Khara said: “We are not playing ball with America and China. We are the ball.”

The government, however, said the new MDR is not a charge on consumers.

Congress spokesperson Supriya Shrinete rejected the government’s position, saying the move would ultimately increase costs for ordinary users.

# RSS affiliate urges govt. to look at ‘broader savings’ before imposing UPI fee

**Ishita Mishra**  
NEW DELHI



Centre has proposed a 0.4% MDR on merchant payments above ₹2,000 through UPI.

Ashwani Mahajan, co-convenor of the Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM), the economic wing of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), on Wednesday raised concern about the government’s proposed merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions above ₹2,000, calling for the move to be reconsidered.

He argued that the fee was not justified by the costs involved.

In a post on X, Mr. Mahajan said there was little reason for banks to seek an MDR on UPI, pointing out that the digital payments system had helped bring down their costs in terms of ATMs and other infrastructure. “UPI transaction fee is most unfortunate. It’s demeaning an achievement of Bharat, which has global appeal. Policymak-

ers have failed to factor in reduced logistics costs due to UPI, making Bharat more competitive,” he said. He also argued that cybersecurity costs should not be cited as a reason for introducing the charge, saying such expenses were part of banks’ regular operations.

The government has proposed a 0.4% MDR on merchant payments above ₹2,000 through UPI. Payments between individuals

and smaller merchant transactions will not attract the fee.

“The question is, why them too?” Mr. Mahajan said, arguing that even bigger merchants shouldn’t be taxed for accepting UPI payments.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Mahajan referred to concerns he had raised in a recent article about the United States Trade Representative and India’s zero-MDR system. The SJM co-convenor said the government should not change its policy because of such pressure. He said the growth of UPI had reduced the business of international card networks such as Visa and Mastercard and helped India save on foreign exchange outgo. “The government should look at the broader savings generated by UPI before going ahead with the proposed fee,” he added.

## IPS officer transferred for using Arabic salutations

**The Hindu Bureau**  
KOLKATA

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government in West Bengal has transferred IPS officer Bushara Bano, after right-wing groups raised objections against a video in which she is heard using common Arabic salutations and greetings. Ms. Bano, who was posted as Additional SP of Kharagpur, has been transferred to the post of Deputy Commandant, SAP 4th Battalion.

In the video, in which Ms. Bano reflects on her personal journey, she is heard saying, “Assalamu Alaikum! I am a 2021-qualified IPS officer and currently deployed as Additional Superintendent of Police in Kharagpur...”

# Oman pitches new port that could expand India’s access to Gulf energy

**Kallol Bhattacharjee**  
NEW DELHI



The Sohar Port is located on the Omani coast on the Gulf of Oman, far from the Strait of Hormuz. FILE PHOTO

With the Strait of Hormuz in a chokehold due to Iran-U.S. hostilities, Oman has pitched investment opportunities to India in a new port that could provide uninterrupted access to energy resources from the Persian Gulf.

Speaking here on Wednesday, a high-level representative of the Sohar Port of Oman welcomed Indian investments into the port and said it would serve as a platform to connect businesses in regional and global markets.

“India represents an important and growing dimension of Sohar’s international investment landscape, with established Indian businesses already contributing to our

industrial ecosystem. There is significant potential to deepen this relationship through investments that complement our industrial clusters, strengthen value chains and create new opportunities for growth,” said Raid Al Rubaiey, CEO of Sohar Freezone and Deputy CEO

of Sohar Port. The port is located on the Omani coast on the Gulf of Oman, and ships can access hubs in the Gulf through this port as it sits far from the Strait of Hormuz.

Mr. Rubaiey said that Sohar Port has received investments of over \$30 billion and that it is capable of

handling 72 million tonnes of cargo annually. “Sohar provides an established industrial and logistics platform connecting businesses to regional and global markets,” he said.

The remarks came at the end of a two-day promotional event organised by the Embassy of Oman, during which the Ambassador of Oman, Issa Saleh Al Shibani, introduced the port and the Freezone to Indian businesses, manufacturers and exporters to increase Indian participation in the port.

Earlier, Oman had offered Duqm and Salalah ports to India, but the Sohar Port has the advantage of being located in the northeast of Oman, close to vital energy pipelines of the United Arab Emirates and eastern Saudi Arabia.

## Mahua says she faced eggs like ‘freedom fighters faced bullets’

**Shiv Sahay Singh**  
KOLKATA



Mahua Moitra

Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra on Wednesday alleged that BJP workers threw eggs at her during a visit to her Krishnanagar constituency in Nadia district of West Bengal.

In a series of posts on X, Ms. Moitra referred to an oral observation made by the Supreme Court last month, when it denied her permission to appear virtually before an investigating officer in a case over her allegedly provocative Facebook posts, on the apprehension that she might be attacked with eggs.

“Big shout out to Hon’ble Justice Dipankar Datta! MiLord - I came to my constituency for a mtng [meeting] informing @WBPolice

& BJP workers with their help pelted eggs on me. True to your advice I faced them as a freedom fighter faced bullets,” she posted.

During the August 7 hearing of Ms. Moitra’s plea, Justice Dipankar Datta had made the oral remarks that freedom fighters had faced bullets, when her counsel cited the possibility of eggs being thrown at her.

## EC calls both Trinamool factions for hearing today

**The Hindu Bureau**  
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission (EC) has called both factions of the Trinamool Congress – one led by former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and the other by Leader of Opposition in the Assembly Ritabrata Banerjee – for hearings again on Thursday.

The EC met both factions on Saturday over their claim on the party name and symbol. The poll body had sought additional documents from the Ritabrata faction. In separate letters dated September 16, the poll body asked the Ritabrata team to reach the EC headquarters in Delhi at 3 p.m. and the Mamata-led grouping at 4 p.m.

E-mail:- acezoneii@yahoo.com/acejipr.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in

**Additional Chief Engineer P.W.D. Zone-II, Jaipur**  
PWD Campus, Jacob Road, Jaipur  
Phone :- 0141-2226537 Ex.:-299

File No. 1254 Date. 12/09/2026

**Short Term NIT NO-27/2026-27**

Bids for “Budget Announcement Year 2026-27, 06 Packages/ Road Works in Jaipur-Rural & Alwar District are invited from interested bidders upto 6.00 PM on dated 23.09.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be seen on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state; and <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in>. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs 2765.25 lacs.

| S. no | UBN              | S. no | UBN              |
|-------|------------------|-------|------------------|
| 1     | PWD2627WSOB11936 | 4     | PWD2627WLOB11934 |
| 2     | PWD2627WSOB11931 | 5     | PWD2627WSOB11933 |
| 3     | PWD2627WSOB11932 | 6     | PWD2627WLOB11935 |

Adtl. Chief Engineer  
**PWD Zone-II Jaipur**

DIPRC/16006/2026

**PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY**  
PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY - 754 142, ODISHA (INDIA)  
MEDICAL DEPARTMENT  
FILE NO. CMO/OEA/IGL/401/2026/1082, DATE: 11.09.2026  
**E-TENDER CALL NOTICE**  
E-tenders are invited on behalf of Paradip Port Authority for the work “Providing manpower for office work, Housekeeping and Para-medical Worker for PPA Hospital”.  
The last date & time of submission of Dt.30.09.2026 on 17.00 Hrs.  
For details, please refer website <http://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>.  
Chief Medical Officer, Paradip Port Authority  
PPA/PR/26/2026-2027, dt.15/09/2026

**सी डैक Centre for Development**  
**CDAC of Advanced Computing**  
**Expression of Interest (Eoi)**  
C-DAC invites Expression of Interest (EOI) for  
“Selection of Industry partner for Development of CT Scanner.”  
For details visit  
‘www.cdac.in’,  
Contact: 0471 2723333,  
9847069184, [tpc@cdac.in](mailto:tpc@cdac.in)

**GOVERNMENT OF PUDUCHERRY**  
**PUDUCHERRY REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY**  
**Office of the Town and Country Planning Department**  
**INVITATION FOR APPLICATION FOR APPOINTMENT OF MEMBERS IN PUDUCHERRY REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY**  
The Government of Puducherry as mandated under section 20 of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016 (No. 16 of 2016) hereby invites applications for appointment of two Members in Puducherry Real Estate Regulatory Authority (PRERA). Complete information on qualification, eligibility criteria, application format and other details may be obtained from the website of Puducherry Real Estate Regulatory Authority (<https://prera.py.gov.in>). Application in the prescribed format along with supporting documents should reach the office of Town and Country Planning Department (TCPD), Puducherry on or before 9th October, 2026 at 5.45 PM. (Note: Those who have already applied pursuant to 10.12.2023 & 10.06.2025 advertisement need not apply again and their applications will be considered subject only to their continuing to be eligible on the cutoff date vide this advertisement).  
**Chief Town Planner, TCPD-Cum- Nodal officer, PRERA**  
Jawahar Nagar, Boomianpet, Puducherry- 605 005  
No:204/DIP/AD(Press)/2026-2027

**कार्यालय अधीक्षक अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, वृत्त बारां**  
क्रमांक : 1767 दिनांक : 03/09/2026  
**निविदा सूचना संख्या 14/2026-27**  
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से बजट घोषणा संख्या 2025-26 में घोषित प्रति विधानसभा क्षेत्र 10.00 करोड़ के नीचे पेवेबल/मिशिन सिक सड़क 1 कार्य एवं बजट घोषणा संख्या 206/2026-27 में घोषित नौन पेवेबल/मिशिन सिक सड़क 4 कार्य (कुल 5 कार्य) हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/डाक एम्स दूर संचार विभाग/रेलवे इत्यादि से संजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के एए श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रयत्न में ई-प्रोक्यूमेंट प्रक्रिया से ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साईट <http://dipr.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। यू.पी.एन संख्या निम्नानुसार है।  
इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेब साईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड होना आवश्यक है।  
NIB Code :- PWD 2627A2610  
UBN No. :- 1- PWD2627WSOB11585, 2- PWD2627WSOB11586, 3- PWD2627WSOB11587  
4- PWD2627WSOB11588, 5- PWD2627WSOB11591  
अधीक्षक अभियन्ता  
सा.नि.वि. वृत्त बारां

DIPRC/15747/2026

**GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**  
**Short Tender Notice No. 50/2026-27/SE(W-East)/EE-East/DB/GV/MC/ Dt:15-09-2026**  
1. No. of Works : 1 No  
2. Value of works (ECV) : Rs.117.84 Lakhs  
3. Down loading Starting Date : 15-09-2026 @ 02.00 P.M.  
4. Down loading End Date : 18-09-2026 @ 02.00 P.M.  
5. Last date for Submission of bid : 18-09-2026 @ 03.00 P.M.  
Further details at <http://www.aeprocurement.gov.in>  
O/o the Executive Engineer (PW-III) Division. **For Commissioner**

E-mail:- acetonk.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in

**Office Of The Additional Chief Engineer P.W.D. Zone-Tonk (Raj.)**  
Bambor Underpass New Housing Board Colony NH-52 Road  
क्रमांक - 1437-1446 दिनांक :- 03.09.2026

**NIB NO-04/2026-27**  
02 Nos. Bids for in SWM District are invited from interested bidders Dated 07-09-2026 to 21.09.2026 upto 6.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be seen on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state; and <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in>. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs.2391.53 Lacs.  
NIB code **PWD2627A2629**  
UBN is: **PWD2627WLOB11695**  
UBN is: **PWD2627WLOB11696**  
**DIPRC/15813/2026**  
(H.L.MEENA)  
**Adtl. Chief Engineer**  
**PWD Zone-Tonk**

**APPOINTMENT**

**Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corporation Ltd. (A Government of India Enterprise-Navratna)**  
**South Central Zone - Secunderabad**  
CIN:L74899DL1999GOH01707

**Walk-in Interview for Qualified Professionals**

Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corporation Ltd (IRCTC Ltd), South Central Zone - Secunderabad intends to engage the services of qualified professionals on contract basis.

1. Hospitality Monitors 2.Tourism Monitors 3.CA/CMA  
Further details viz, for eligibility criteria, walk-in interview date/venue and other terms & conditions of engagement visit: [www.irctc.com](http://www.irctc.com).

**OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PHED CIRCLE NAGAU**  
No:- TA/2026-27/3789-3795 Date: 11.09.2026  
**NOTICE INVITING BID 13-14/2026-27**  
Bid for Commissioning work of HP/TW (Nit No 13-14/2026-27 and are invited from interested bidders upto 06.00 PM 24.09.2026 and 30.09.2026 other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state; phedwater.rajasthan.gov.in departmental website.  
NIT No. SPPP UBN No  
13/2026-27 PHE 2627 WSRC 05172  
14/2026-27 PHE 2627 WSRC 05173  
“SAVE WATER-SAVE LIFE”  
(SHRAWAN SINGH KHIRIA)  
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER  
PHED CIRCLE NAGAU

DIPRC/15975/2026

**भूमि कार्यालय अधीक्षक अभियन्ता सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग खण्ड वेम्**  
क्रमांक / निविदा / एफ-106/26-27/721 दिनांक :- 07.09.2026  
**Notice Inviting Bid No:- 10/2026-27**  
Bids for 01 Nos. Work Construction of open M.S. Shed for Work School Work under DMFT 2025-26 & 2026-27, & 15 Construction of Various School Class Room under DMFT 2026-27 & 01 MS Sheed Construction Work & 1 work CD Repair SR to CD Work 2026-27 & 01 Nos. Work Rate Contract for VIP VISIT at PWD Dn Begun Procurement are invited from interested bidders upto 6.00 PM of 22.09.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 415.53 Lacs.  
NIB CODE:- PWD2627A2646  
UBN CODE:-  
1. PWD2627WSOB11746 2. PWD2627WSOB11747 3. PWD2627WSOB11748  
4. PWD2627WSOB11749 5. PWD2627WSOB11750 6. PWD2627WSOB11751  
7. PWD2627WSOB11752 8. PWD2627WSOB11753 9. PWD2627WSOB11754  
10. PWD2627WSOB11755 11. PWD2627WSOB11756 12. PWD2627WSOB11757  
13. PWD2627WSOB11758 14. PWD2627WSOB11759 15. PWD2627WSOB11760  
16. PWD2627WSOB11761 17. PWD2627WSOB11762 18. PWD2627WSOB11763  
(Ramkesh Meena)  
Executive Engineer  
PWD Dn. Begun  
Telephone No. 01474-294110  
DIPRC/15837/2026 E-mail:- eepwd.begun@rediffmail.com

**NATIONAL BOARD OF EXAMINATIONS IN MEDICAL SCIENCES**  
(Autonomous body of the M/o. Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)  
**NAMS Building, Medical Enclave, Ansari Nagar**  
**New Delhi – 110029**

**FOREIGN MEDICAL GRADUATE EXAMINATION (FMGE) – OCTOBER 2026**  
**NOTICE**

National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) shall conduct the **FMGE – OCTOBER 2026 on 31-10-2026.**

Applications are being invited from **11-09-2026 (05:00PM Onwards) to 25-09-2026 (Till 11:55 PM)** at NBEMS website:  
**<https://natboard.edu.in/viewnbexam?exam=fmge>**

There is no other method for submitting the application other than the above online method. Applications submitted through any other medium will be summarily rejected.

**Candidate Care Support: +91-7996165333**  
**Helpline Portal on applicant login page**  
**Communication Web Portal on NBEMS Website**

INBRIEF



PM Mementos e-Auction's eighth edition begins today

A total of 1,498 gifts received by Prime Minister Narendra Modi will go under the hammer at the eighth edition of the PM Mementos e-Auction, to be held in New Delhi from September 17 to October 31. The e-auction offers citizens, collectors, institutions, and art and culture enthusiasts an opportunity to acquire the unique mementos presented to the Prime Minister on various occasions. The auction would be held through [www.pmmementos.gov.in](http://www.pmmementos.gov.in). In this edition, 50 ‘Hero Objects’ have been identified, representing some of the distinctive pieces in the collection, including a Sri Ranganathaswamy Tanjore-style framed painting.

Uttar Pradesh ATS arrests T.N. youth over terror group links

The Uttar Pradesh Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) has arrested a 19-year-old youth from Tamil Nadu for alleged involvement in conspiring to carry out “violent jihadist activities” and being part of WhatsApp groups that contained bomb-making videos and material linked to Al Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent (AQIS). Maqsood Ali, who was allegedly in touch with Pakistani hackers and had developed a secure communication network for others like him, was arrested from Coimbatore on Monday with the assistance of the Tamil Nadu ATS, officials said on Wednesday. This was the second arrest in the case within the last few days. PTI

Delhi HC asks Centre's plan for regulating social media

The Delhi High Court on Wednesday asked the Centre to respond whether it was contemplating formulating a policy to regulate addition-causing design features on social media platforms like infinite scroll and autoplay. A Bench said it would hear a PIL plea seeking constitution of an expert committee to examine engagement-maximising and addiction-causing design features on social media platforms after three weeks. It asked Additional Solicitor-General Chetan Sharma to take instructions on the issue. Mr. Sharma said that it will be in the domain of the policy-makers to consider some of the issues raised in the plea.

Govt. asks cab aggregators to stop advance tipping option

The government has ordered cab aggregators to stop providing advance tipping options even before booking a ride, as the practice is misleading and unfair, Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare said on Wednesday. The secretary's comment comes a day after the Central Consumer Protection Authority slapped a ₹10 lakh penalty on ride-hailing platform Rapido for various unfair business practices. The authority is currently examining the business practices of Uber and Ola. Responding to queries related to taxi ride aggregators, Ms. Khare said the National Consumer Helpline has received a lot of complaints against them. PTI

‘Census Town’ definition is outdated: Ministry to panel

Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry says the four-decade-old definition ignores economic change, regional diversity, and peri-urban growth; RGI has decided to continue with it despite objections

Sobhana K. Nair  
NEW DELHI

The four-decade-old criteria used to classify Census Towns will not be able to capture the actual scale of urbanisation in India, the Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry told a parliamentary committee, arguing that the present rigid definition, which the Registrar-General of India (RGI) has decided to continue with despite the Ministry's objections, does not account for economic and spatial transformations.

A draft report, “Census Criteria for Defining Urban Areas”, was discussed by the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Housing and Urban Affairs, headed by TDP MP Magunta Sreenivasulu Reddy, on Wednesday. The Ministry, while depositing before the panel, said the old “rural-urban” binary was outdated and inadequate because of the diversity and complexity of economic activity.

The Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) argues that



Taking count: The Registrar-General of India has said that it was too late to alter the framework for Census 2027. FILE PHOTO

the country's urbanisation level could have been as high as 63% in 2015 based on satellite data – more than double the official Census 2011 estimate of 31%. According to the 2011 Census, out of the total population of 121 crore, around 83.3 crore Indians or nearly 68.8% of people live in rural areas, while 37.7 crore people or 31.2% of the population reside in urban areas

A Census Town is defined as a village with a minimum population of 5,000, at least 75% of the male working population

engaged in non-agricultural pursuits, and a population density of at least 400 persons per sq. km. The definition has remained unchanged since 1981.

Male bias questioned

In a communication to the RGI in February 2024, the Ministry had flagged several issues with the continued use of the 1981 definition. It objected to uniform national thresholds, saying they disadvantaged hilly and northeastern States. The Ministry also questioned the “male bias”, where only the male work-

ing population was being used as a parameter to define a town. The female workforce participation should also be utilised, it said.

The Ministry also said population density was calculated using administrative boundaries rather than built-up areas, resulting in misclassification of settlements. It proposed greater use of satellite imagery and suggested a “transitional areas” category to better capture rapidly urbanising regions.

The Ministry further argued that the binary rural-urban classification overlooked peri-urban settlements and growth corridors that functioned like urban areas. It said the current system, based on data from the previous Census, could lead to both exclusion and inclusion errors. However, the RGI maintained that it was too late to alter the framework for Census 2027, as enumeration blocks, boundaries, training and field deployment depending on the rural-urban classification being finalised in advance.

NEET-UG follow-up: NTA seeks subject experts, translators

Maitri Porecha  
NEW DELHI

The National Testing Agency (NTA) has invited applications from experienced educators, researchers, and academics for the empanelment of subject matter experts and translation reviewers as part of its overhaul following the NEET-UG paper leak earlier this year.

The NTA has removed 600 subject matter experts, including external, contracted, and panel-based personnel who were responsible for creating question papers, translating content, and conducting psychometric reviews, after it was found that some of them were compromised and responsible for the leak. They are now being replaced.

The agency has stated that experts can submit their Expressions of Interest on the NTA portal till October 9.

“If you are passionate about maintaining pedagogical excellence, academic integrity, and rigorous assessment standards across India's premier national-level examinations, this is your opportunity to contribute directly to the

National Testing Agency has removed 600 subject matter experts after the NEET-UG paper leak

examination ecosystem,” the NTA said on X.

The NTA is seeking subject matter experts who can contribute to formulation of questions by crafting high-order thinking, and application-based and syllabus-aligned questions, the agency has specified. It is looking for subject matter experts who can conduct review and vetting by scrutinising test items for conceptual accuracy, clarity, and difficulty calibration.

The subject matter experts should be fluent in moderation and ensuring standardisation, neutrality, and adherence to exam blueprints. They should also be sound in translation and “trans adaptation” by providing precise, culturally and linguistically sound translations. Serving or retired faculty, professors, school educators, and domain specialists with demonstrable subject expertise can apply, the NTA has said.

‘Academic freedom severely restricted under current govt.’

Maitri Porecha  
NEW DELHI

India's academic freedom has been “severely restricted” under the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government, according to the annual “Free to Think 2026” report released by Scholars at Risk's (SAR), an international network of higher education institutions that works to protect threatened scholars and promote academic freedom, headquartered at New York University.

According to the report, India's Academic Freedom Index (AFI) score decreased from 0.16 in 2024 to 0.14 in 2026, with both values falling in the “severely restricted” category, next to its neighbours China (0.07) and Afghanistan (0.09), where academic freedom was in the “completely restricted” category.

India's AFI value has declined significantly over the last decade, from 0.41 in 2015.

The AFI is measured on a scale of 0 to 1 and assesses parameters like campus integrity, freedom of academic expression, freedom of academic exchange and dissemination, freedom to research and teach and institutional autonomy.

The report documents 382 attacks arising from 321 verified incidents in 59 countries and territories, as reported by SAR's Academic Freedom Monitoring Project from July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2026. Of the 382, India accounted for the highest number of attacks, with 42 cases, the report noted. These attacks included violence, imprisonment or loss of position of academics or students.

Same-sex partner can be made nominee for medical decisions, Centre tells HC

The Hindu Bureau  
NEW DELHI

The Centre has told the Delhi High Court that an adult can nominate a partner, including one in a non-heterosexual relationship, to make medical decisions if they become incapacitated, potentially opening the way for same-sex partners to act for each other despite existing rules not clearly recognising such arrangements.

The submission comes in a case filed by Arshiya Takkar, who has been in a relationship with her partner since 2015 and married her in New Zealand in 2023. Her plea highlighted that in the event of a medical emergency, she could be left without any legal mechanism to make critical decisions for her partner, despite the couple having

Govt. says such a nomination could be subject to applicable law and appropriate safeguards

lived together in Delhi since 2018.

Responding to her plea, the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and the National Medical Commission said that allowing a competent adult to nominate a partner, including one in a same-sex relationship, to take medical decisions in the event of incapacity was “substantially capable of being accommodated within the existing legal and ethical framework”.

“Permitting a competent adult to nominate his/her partner, including a partner in a non-heterosexual/same-sex relationship,

to take medical decisions on his/her behalf in the event of incapacity would constitute a logical and tailored extension of the same principle,” the affidavit said. It added that such a nomination could be subject to appropriate safeguards and the applicable law.

It further submitted that where a competent adult has nominated or otherwise authorised their partner to act on their behalf in the event of incapacity, “there appears to be no medical or ethical rationale for excluding such person merely on account of the sex, gender or sexual orientation of the partners or because their union does not fall within the conventional understanding of marriage..”

The petition is likely to come up for hearing on Thursday.

India remains at 131st rank in global gender parity index

Press Trust of India  
NEW DELHI/GENEVA

India retained the 131st rank on the Global Gender Gap Index 2026 released by the World Economic Forum on Wednesday, with Iceland, Finland and Norway maintaining their top three slots respectively.

The 14 countries ranked below than India on the index include Papua New Guinea, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Tajikistan, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Morocco, Mali, Algeria, and Congo.

Chad was the lowest-ranked country in the index, with Iran and Pakistan joining it in the bottom three.

For India, the progress towards gender parity stood at 64.5%, below the global average. While India's score improved slightly over the last year, its global ranking remained unchanged at 131st.

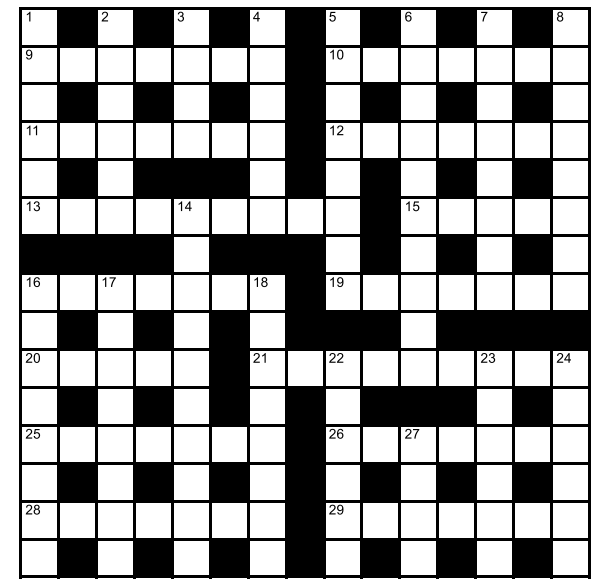
**THE CROSSWORD**

14900

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY

(set by Arden)



15. Rob on average, shows no anger (5)  
16. Country song about soldiers (7)  
19. In money collection, company shows thrift (7)  
20. Pen stand? (5)  
21. Spinner of yarns right in front of a working counter (9)  
25. Added about hundred and formed froth on top (7)  
26. Drop line for a scapegoat (4,3)  
28. Force one to come in and sign up for jury duty (7)  
29. Checked regular trend to follow German car (7)
- DOWN
1. Language of north central Africa fashionable to adopt nowadays (6)  
2. Parrot became a bird of prey (6)  
3. Feature of a country, in brief (4)  
4. Girl takes old boyfriend in her wing (6)  
5. Fantastic treasure trove - taking wrong route to cross (8)  
6. Adjust dimmers - have to cool it (6,4)  
7. American influence on a party and state (8)  
8. Banks' same rate - note lady does it calmly (8)  
14. Writer's tragic life - one enters China (3,7)  
16. Both sides like to secure pole position - wrongdoing is a killer (8)  
17. Paul came out to admit mistake (3,5)  
18. A terrier gets refreshed with a beer (8)  
22. Able to cover the backside with a robe (6)  
23. Maybe they can drink one gallon - that's four times score (6)  
24. On fourth day, I returned the partly paid up capital (6)  
27. Marriage vow by the lake fountain (4)

- ACROSS
9. Warm layer is savage (7)  
10. Capital housing - last letter follows greeting from Ginger, perhaps (7)  
11. Relaxation by the river sipping wine (7)  
12. Run away velocity of a horny creature (7)  
13. Rifleman's job is to protect store (9)

SUDOKU

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| 4 |   |   |   |   | 3 |   |   |
| 2 | 9 |   | 7 |   |   | 4 | 8 |
|   |   | 8 |   |   |   |   | 2 |
|   | 7 |   | 1 | 5 |   |   |   |
|   | 1 |   |   | 2 |   |   | 4 |
| 3 |   |   |   |   |   | 7 |   |

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

|                             |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
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| Solution to previous puzzle |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| S                           | T | U | D | E | N | A | P |
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| A                           | D | O | E | R | S | T | O |
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| 9 | 5 | 1 | 4 | 7 | 8 | 2 | 6 | 3 |
| 8 | 2 | 7 | 6 | 3 | 9 | 1 | 4 | 5 |
| 4 | 6 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 5 | 9 | 7 | 8 |
| 2 | 3 | 8 | 7 | 9 | 4 | 5 | 1 | 6 |
| 7 | 9 | 6 | 5 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 8 | 4 |
| 5 | 1 | 4 | 3 | 8 | 6 | 7 | 2 | 9 |
| 1 | 7 | 5 | 8 | 4 | 3 | 6 | 9 | 2 |
| 3 | 8 | 9 | 2 | 6 | 7 | 4 | 5 | 1 |
| 6 | 4 | 2 | 9 | 5 | 1 | 8 | 3 | 7 |

FAITH

Devotion of Gopikas

Srimad Bhagavatam explores the supreme devotion of the Gopikas towards Lord Krishna during the Rasa Leela, said Navalpakkam Sri Ramachar in a discourse. On a serene, moonlit autumn night, Lord Krishna decides to engage in divine pastimes with the Gopikas of Vrindavan. To gather them without sending formal messengers, He plays His divine flute. Upon hearing the sweet music, the Gopikas abandon their household chores, families, and sleeping infants, rushing out into the forest in utter haste. When they arrive, Lord Krishna tests their steadfastness by advising them to return home. They say their minds have been completely stolen by His flute song, making it impossible for them to return to worldly life.

Moved by their devotion, Krishna initially grants their wish and joins them in the Rasa Leela, but soon disappears to dissolve any subtle pride (*Ahankara*) within them. Devastated by His sudden separation, the Gopikas wander through the forests of Vrindavan. Unable to find Him, they gather on the banks of the Yamuna and sing the Gopika Geetham, expressing their intense longing and glorifying His divine nature. They glorify His lotus-like eyes and beg for His compassionate glance, making four heartfelt requests: that He place His reassuring lotus hands upon their heads, allow them to behold His smiling face, rest His holy feet – which walked the pastures and conquered Kaliya – upon their hearts, and grant them the nectar of His life-restoring words. Touched by their selfless love and poignant stanzas, Lord Krishna reappears before them. Overjoyed, the Gopikas welcome Him back in various loving ways, completely forgetting their grief.

Business

INBRIEF



Ahead of festive season, BIS raises gold hallmarking fee

The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) has revised hallmarking charges for gold and silver articles, raising the fee for gold to ₹75 from ₹45, while retaining the charge for silver at ₹35, with immediate effect ahead of the festive season. The increase has been notified through the BIS (Hallmarking) Amendment Regulations, 2026. Jewellers are required to pay a hallmarking fee of ₹75 per article, subject to a minimum charge of ₹200 per consignment. PTI

Commercial coal auction 16th round to be launched today

The Coal Ministry will launch the 16th round of commercial coal mine auctions on Thursday. The latest round will offer a fresh set of fully explored and partially explored coal blocks, the ministry said in a statement on Wednesday. “The 16th round is expected to carry this progress forward by bringing additional coal blocks into production, generating further employment and attracting new investment into the sector,” the ministry said in the statement. PTI

NSE raises ₹6,746 cr.in anchor round ahead of mega IPO

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) on Wednesday garnered ₹6,746 crore from anchor investors, including Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), Goldman Sachs and Fidelity, ahead of the opening of its much-awaited IPO subscription. Additionally, sovereign wealth funds GIC Singapore, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Norges Bank as well as Eastspring and HSBC Global Asset Management participated in the anchor round. PTI

Why private banks stand to gain from the MDR charge

The Hindu analysed data from the NPCI to find out how much money can be made from the Merchant Discount Rate charge on UPI transactions and who stands to benefit the most from it

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan  
NEW DELHI

The new Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI will affect a tiny proportion of UPI users, and benefit a small number of banks – predominantly private ones like Yes Bank – and a few UPI apps such as Walmart-owned PhonePe, and Google Pay, National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) data showed.

The NPCI has said that starting October 15, 2026, an MDR of 0.4% will be charged on UPI payments of ₹2,000 or more made to mid and large merchants.

This will mean that only about 2.5% of UPI transactions by volume will face the charge. All Person-to-Person (P2P) transactions will remain free of charge, regardless of the amount being transferred. Further, payments to merchants up to ₹2,000 will remain free of MDR.

In addition, the NPCI has mandated that small merchants including street vendors receiving up to ₹1 lakh per month through UPI QR codes under the Person-to-Person-Merchant (P2PM) category will also be exempt from MDR.

Transactions of ₹2,000 or more in essential and thin-margin sectors, such as railways, telecommunications, insurance, fuel, and agricultural inputs, will attract a flat MDR of ₹5 per transaction. Further, capital market transac-

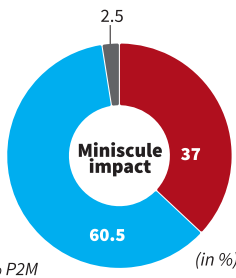
Trailing transactions

The data were sourced from the National Payments Corporation of India



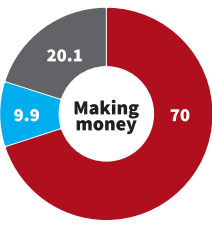
Only person-to-merchant payments above ₹2,000 will attract Merchant Discount Rates (MDR)

Note: Even within the 2.5% P2M transactions above ₹2,000, payments to small merchants are exempt



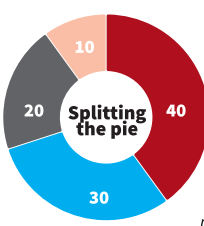
Only one-fifth of the value of all transactions will yield Merchant Discount Rates

The chart shows shares (%) in the value of total UPI transactions in August 2026

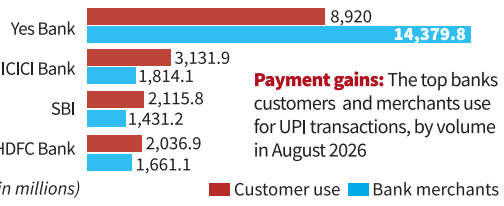


The MDR at 0.4% on P2M transactions above ₹2,000, transactions will result in a maximum revenue of ₹2,400 crore per month based on current trends. Even within this upper limit, since there are exemptions for small merchants, sectoral caps, and a flat rate included in the mechanism, actual revenues will likely be lower

The chart shows each payment player's share (%) in the MDR that is collected.



The biggest share of MDR goes to the customer's or payer's bank. The 2nd-highest goes to the merchant's bank, followed by the UPI apps, and other payment processors.



Among UPI apps, PhonePe and GPay make up 80% of transaction volume and will receive the largest MDR share



tions such as payments to mutual funds, stockbrokers, dealers, and for equities will attract an MDR of 0.02%, capped at ₹300 per transaction.

The transactions that will face MDR account for only about 20% of the value of all UPI transactions done. So, at the maximum, this will result in about ₹2,400 crore of revenue generated per month.

Of the MDR that is collected, the biggest share goes to the customer's or payer's bank. The second-highest share goes to the merchant's bank, followed by the UPI apps, and other payment processors.

Among the banks that customers seem to use for UPI payments, Yes Bank emerges as the leader by a huge margin, followed by ICICI Bank. Even among

the banks used by merchants to receive UPI payments, Yes Bank is far and away the favourite followed by Axis Bank, ICICI Bank, and HDFC Bank.

Of the UPI apps that people use, PhonePe and Google Pay together account for nearly 80% of the volume of transactions, which means they will receive the largest chunk of MDR collected.

Copper price surge hits margins for EVs, consumer, engineering goods

Saptaparno Ghosh  
NEW DELHI

Copper's recent rally to record-highs has sent waves of concern reverberating through the makers of consumer and industrial products such as electric vehicles (EVs), consumer gadgets and appliances, electric wires and engineering goods, among others.

Futures of the metal on the London Metal Exchange (LME), the benchmark for global prices, hit an all-time-high of \$14,779 per tonne on September 8.

While prices have marginally slid from the highs, they are still elevated. On Wednesday afternoon, copper futures were trading about 0.9% higher over its previous close of \$14,167.67 per tonne.

Prices rallied in the past couple of weeks as purchasers in the U.S. stockpile anticipating U.S. President Donald Trump's imposition of steep tariffs on refined copper import.

This combines with the fact global economy is already navigating lower copper output in the first half of the calendar year.

India imports about 85% of its copper requirements. The cascading effect on profit margin is likely to be acute for industries where copper is irreplaceable.

Cost pressures

Copper wire makers, including Finolex, Polycab and Havells, hiked prices in September to mitigate some of the cost pressures.

Mahesh Viswanathan, CEO, Finolex Cables, said the price trend in the last one year has forced market-wide pricing realignments across the electrical manufacturing sector.



Hardening prices: The LME benchmark for global prices, hit an all-time-high of \$14,779 per ton on September 8. REUTERS

“The initial brief trade-level destocking only reflected short-term inventory recalibration. However, the demand in power and construction sectors ensured complete absorption of the prices,” he said.

Copper is regarded as ideal base material in wires making due to its ability to withstand heat and being a good conductor, among other things, thus, making it difficult to find an alternative. The same problem exists in EV industry also.

According to Ajay Sharma, DG and CEO of the Electric Vehicle Industry Alliance (EVIA), EVs use “about 3-4% more copper” than traditional combustion vehicles adding rising copper prices would induce pricing pressures.

He said though the industry is exploring wider use of aluminium to cut costs and make vehicles even lighter, copper cannot be entirely replaced.

“Aluminium offers 61% electrical conductivity of copper, thus, aluminium conductors need to be 1.6-times larger to carry same electrical load,” he said.

Consumer electronics

Makers of consumer appliances and gadgets are also keeping a close eye on

copper, especially ahead of the festive season.

The same paradigm extends for engineering goods manufacturers.

Jayakumar Ramadas of Mahendra Pumps observed copper prices had become “unreasonable.”

Sanjay Chitkara, director & co-chief sales & marketing officer, LG Electronics India told The Hindu, “We are closely monitoring input costs and evaluating pricing in a calibrated manner, while balancing cost pressures with consumer affordability and the competitive environment.”

Saket Singh, an executive at Chennai-based chip design firm Aheesa, told The Hindu there may be a price adjustment in the electronics manufacturing industry but that it may not be a significant sum.

Supply pressure

A spokesperson of the Federation of Indian Mineral Industries (FIMI) told The Hindu the global copper market was now experiencing tightness in mine and concentrate supply, with production constraints in some major producing regions, including Chile, putting further pressure on overall availability. “During the first half of

2026, global copper mine and concentrate output were lower than in the same period last year. At the same time, demand from power infrastructure, electrification, data centres and other industrial applications continues to support the market.”

FIMI noted uncertainty over potential U.S. tariff steps on refined copper also influenced trade flows.

It has led to additional copper flows into the U.S. whilst hitting availability in other markets, it said.

“For India, these developments can raise the landed cost of copper. In addition to international prices, higher freight costs, vessel constraints and, where already there, longer or rerouted shipping routes will add to the delivered cost,” said the spokesperson.

FIMI further observed the resulting regional price differentials affected physical arbitrage flows between major copper futures markets, including Shanghai Futures Exchange (SFE) and Chicago Mercantile Exchange (CME).

“While price differences normally encourage physical movement between markets, tariff expectations and regional supply conditions can temporarily redirect these flows and widen regional price differentials,” it observed.

FIMI added the developments underline the importance of India diversifying copper supply sources, boosting local output, recycling and developing resilient global supply chains to manage supply disruptions, trade uncertainty and higher logistics costs.

(With inputs from Aroon Deep, Soundariya Preetha and Haider Ali Khan)

Beyond rate cuts, eye compliance and revenue, FM urges industry

Mini Tejaswi  
BENGALURU

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman urged industry stakeholders to ensure that tax policy recommendations submitted to the government address broader issues, including compliance costs, revenue implications and potential unintended consequences, rather than focusing merely on demands for rate cuts, exemptions or concessions.

Speaking at the 8th International Tax Conference on “New Age Taxation”, organised by the International Tax Research



Nirmala Sitharaman

and Analysis Foundation (ITRAF) here, Ms. Sitharaman said tax consultations should be a genuine exercise involving “evidence, experience and ideas”

rather than merely providing stakeholders an opportunity to place representations on record. She also urged academics, researchers, and think tanks to produce independent tax policy studies that help improve public discourse on taxation.

Asking what kind of tax system India should have over the next two decades as the country moves towards Viksit Bharat by 2047; she said “such an approach requires better tax policy research, looks at a proposal from all sides, measures its effects, recognises the trade-offs and wherever possible offers a

workable alternative.”

Year after year most industry representations have three requests: reduce a rate, provide an exemption, or grant a concession, and that wasn't enough, she said, adding that a mature tax policy debate must go beyond sectoral interests and examine whether existing provisions continued to serve their purpose.

Calling for stronger, independent tax policy research in India, she asked ITRAF to play a larger role in shaping policy as India needed more visible and rigorous independent tax research.

FCNR(B) deposits saved India from a BoP deficit in July

Ashokamithran T.  
MUMBAI

India's balance of payments (BoP) received a significant boost in July 2026 as non-resident Indian (NRI) deposits under the FCNR(B) scheme surged to \$33.5 billion, accounting for a substantial share of the country's capital account surplus during the month.

The capital account surplus widened to \$27.7 billion in July 2026, nearly eight times the \$3.5 billion recorded in July 2025. Dollar denominated bank deposits from NRIs contributed to most of this.

Without the RBI's special scheme, NRI deposits would have remained at their usual monthly level of \$1 billion. Combined with a \$15 billion outflow in other bank capital, this would have pushed the capital account into a \$4.8 billion deficit. When added to the \$7 billion current account deficit, India's overall BoP would have faced an \$11.8 billion deficit, which would have marked the third month of deficit had it not been for FCNR

(B) deposits.

RBI's special deposit scheme attracted \$127 billion in NRI deposits, with more than 26% of the inflows recorded in July 2026. This helped keep the capital account in a \$27.7 billion surplus and the overall BoP at a \$20.8 billion surplus during the reporting month.

“FCNR(B) inflows and more of External Commercial Borrowings (ECB) inflows for a few more months kept the current month and the whole fiscal year comfortable for the balance of payment. This can be a one time comfort and may not be available next year,” said Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist of Bank of Baroda.

Focussing on FDI is the crux and FII outflows should slow down and turn positive for the capital account to be in a self-sustaining surplus, he said. Given the global conditions, it may be difficult for significant inflows of FII or FDI to come in. This can mean a continued pressure on the foreign exchange reserves, Mr. Sabnavis added.

Full Cuppa

NRI deposits saved the BoP position from a deficit and is expected to keep it that way for the rest of the fiscal year

| Month        | Balance of payments actual* | Balance of payments assuming FCNR(B)* flows were same as April to June levels |
|--------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| April 2026 P | -6.6                        | -6.6                                                                          |
| May 2026 P   | -4.4                        | -4.4                                                                          |
| June 2026 P  | 2.9                         | 2.9                                                                           |
| July 2026 P  | 20.8                        | -11.8                                                                         |

P: provisional  
\* figures in \$ billion  
Source: RBI



Govt. lifts registration rule for small exporters in a bid to ease compliance burden

The Hindu Bureau  
NEW DELHI

The Government has exempted small exporters from having to officially register, in a bid to reduce compliance burden and facilitate exports via post, courier and other emerging channels, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry announced on Wednesday.

“The Government has introduced a de minimis exemption from the requirement of Registration-cum-Membership Certificate (RCMC) or Certificate of Registration for small-value export consignments up to ₹3 lakh,” the Ministry said in a release.

“The measure is aimed



The move may cover a substantial number of small-value transactions.

at reducing the compliance burden for new and small exporters and facilitating exports through Postal, Courier and other emerging channels,” it added.

According to the data presented by the government covering 2021-22 to 2025-26, low-value exports

account for a significant share of shipping bills but a very small proportion of the overall export value.

“Consignments up to \$3,000, for instance, account for 43% of shipping bills but only 0.86% of India's total merchandise export value,” the Centre said. “The exemption is therefore expected to cover a substantial number of small-value export transactions while having only a marginal impact on the overall value of exports.”

Prior to this change, exporters had to obtain an RCMC or Certificate of Registration from the relevant export promotion council or the commodity board.

RBI absorbs ₹2.9 lakh cr. to suck excess liquidity

The Hindu Bureau  
MUMBAI

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) absorbed almost ₹2.9 lakh crore from the banking system through overnight Variable Rate Reverse Repo (VRRR) auctions on September 16, as part of its efforts to suck excess liquidity.

The RBI conducted the liquidity-absorption operation in two tranches. The first auction, targeting ₹2,50,025 crore, received bids worth ₹3,17,088 crore.

The central bank accepted ₹2.5 lakh crore at a cut-off rate of 5.4%, which was also the weighted average rate. In the second auction, the RBI set a target of ₹1 lakh crore but got bids worth only ₹40,302 crore.



GETTING A LOOK-IN

Varun ruled out of Asian Games, Vipraj named as replacement



FILE PHOTO

Vipraj Nigam will replace Varun Chakaravarthy in India's Asian Games squad after the latter was ruled out of the continental event with a side strain. **The squad:** Shreyas (Capt.), Tilak (Vice-capt.), Abhishek, Samson (wk), Kishan (wk), Dube, Axar, Washington, Bishnoi, Bumrah, Arshdeep, Sooryavanshi, Yash Thakur, and Vipraj.

GOLD DUST

He bowls the same way whenever you bowl him: Aakash on Bumrah



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Former India cricketer Aakash Chopra praised the team's bowling unit for maintaining control in the second T20I against Afghanistan. Hailing Jasprit Bumrah's economical spell, he said, "Bumrah conceded 25 runs in four overs and picked up a wicket. He is gold. He bowls the same way whenever you bowl him."

LEAD CHARACTER

Brook's unbeaten hundred sets up England's mammoth victory



REUTERS

England captain Harry Brook smashed 10 fours and six sixes in an unbeaten 114 off just 49 balls to set up a 119-run win over Sri Lanka in the first of three T20Is at Southampton on Tuesday. **The scores:** England 254/4 in 20 overs (Brook 114 n.o., Buttler 80) bt Sri Lanka 135 in 19 overs (Wellalage 33, Baker 3/12). **Toss:** SL. **PoM:** Brook.

PROLIFIC

Buttler overtakes Rohit to become second-highest T20I run-scorer



REUTERS

England's Jos Buttler surpassed Rohit Sharma to become the second-highest run-scorer in T20Is. Buttler achieved the feat with his 44-ball 80 during England's first T20I against Sri Lanka. Buttler has 4,292 runs in 161 T20Is, moving past Rohit (4,231 in 159). Pakistan's Babar Azam leads the charts (4,596 in 145).

India aims for a series sweep, Afghans hope to script a win

Samson's half-century and Nitish's three-wicket haul in the second T20I a welcome sign for Shreyas & Co.; after two ducks, opener Gurbaz will be keen to get going

CRICKET

Vivek Krishnan  
NEW DELHI

Business as usual. That is how India's T20I series win over Afghanistan has seemed, having barely dropped a bead of sweat whilst registering consecutive seven-wicket wins at the Arun Jaitley Stadium in the national capital. The tour of the United Kingdom in June-July, where India went without a victory in six completed T20Is against Ireland and England, may have thrown a spanner in the works in Shreyas Iyer's first assignment as captain. But back in familiar territory, albeit Afghanistan is the official host for the ongoing series, India has reiterated its near-impregnability.

Numbers bear testimony. Since July 2024, the Men in Blue have won 23 out of 27 T20Is in India. This splendid run includes the T20 World Cup in February and March, which they lifted for the second time in succession. They have prevailed in every bilateral assignment in India in this phase.

If the possibility of Afghanistan causing an upset was faint before the series, the last vestiges of hope vanished into thin air once India won the toss and opted to chase under lights in both fixtures.



Dominant: An all-round show by India has proved too much for Afghanistan. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Considering the ease with which Shreyas & Co. have knocked off targets of 157 and 160, Afghanistan's spin department, known to be its strong suit, has had to face some of the heat. But the Rashid Khan-led attack hasn't been aided one bit by the below-par returns of the batters. "The par total on that wicket would be about 200. That would have given us something realistic to bowl at. We didn't set a target that could have been defended," Afghanistan coach Richard Pybus rued after the loss in the second T20I on Tuesday. If Ibrahim Zadran's men are to salvage a win in Thursday's dead rubber, one among the top four

will have to bat deep. Rahmanullah Gurbaz, who has been dismissed on nought both times, will hope to be that batter. "Gurbaz is usually our most explosive player in the top-order. I know he's really disappointed. He loves the big occasions. I'm sure he'll have something special for us in the third game," said Pybus. From India's perspective, it couldn't have asked for a better tune-up to the Asian Games in Japan. All its parts are in order, with Sanju Samson's half-century and Nitish Kumar's three-wicket haul in the second T20I arousing further confidence within the camp. Before the players board

the flight to eastern Asia to defend their gold medal, rest assured that a series whitewash will be on their radar. **The teams (from): Afghanistan:** Ibrahim Zadran (Capt.), Darwish Rasooli, Noor ul Rahman (wk), Rahmanullah Gurbaz (wk), Sediqullah Atal, Azmatullah Omarzai, Gulbadin Naib, Mohammad Nabi, Nangeyalia Kharote, Rashid Khan, Abdullah Ahmadzai, Fazalhaq Farooqi, Mujeeb Ur Rahman, Naveen-ul-Haq, and Noor Ahmad. **India:** Shreyas Iyer (Capt.), Tilak Varma, Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Sanju Samson (wk), Ishan Kishan (wk), Shivam Dube, Nitish Kumar, Axar Patel, Washington Sundar, Ravi Bishnoi, Jasprit Bumrah, Arshdeep Singh, and Yash Thakur. *Match starts at 7.30 p.m.*



Topsy-turvy ride: Samson was back to wielding his willow like a cutlass with a blistering 57 off 22 balls. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

I try to shut out the noise, says Samson

Vivek Krishnan  
NEW DELHI

The past few months have proved to be a microcosm of Sanju Samson's chequered international career. If his form at the business end of this year's T20 World Cup – he won the Player-of-the-Tournament award with 321 runs in five innings – was a dazzling high, the tour of the United Kingdom just three months later was a debilitating low. After just two games against Ireland and one against England, which yielded returns of 5, 0 and 1, he made way for teen prodigy Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. While Samson came back for the fifth and final T20I against the Englishmen, he had already been omitted for the subsequent tour of Zimbabwe. Samson's topsy-turvy ride hasn't halted. At the Arun Jaitley Stadium on Tuesday, the 31-year-old from Kerala was back to wielding his willow like a cutlass, scything the Afghanistan attack for a blistering 57 off 22 balls in a

chase of 160. In the aftermath, Samson spoke with refreshing candour and endearing wit, and showed no resentment at recent developments. "After a few failures, you definitely go through a lot as an Indian cricketer. It is not easy to face failures. But that is where my experience comes in. I try to shut out the noise and still try to keep scoring at a high strike rate," the opener told reporters. At a time when social media is all-pervasive, how does he stay immune to the outside noise? "I try to switch off the wi-fi," he chuckled. "But sometimes the wi-fi switches on and the comments of some former players crop up. It is their choice to say what they want to say. I have become mature and experienced enough to handle that. It does affect you. We are not robots. But I try to be clear. If I was affected by the noise, I wouldn't be able to play the way I do. Before every attacking shot, I would be thinking 10 times."

Nabi, Naman get ODI call-ups for WI series

Sports Bureau  
NEW DELHI

Auqib Nabi and Naman Dhir have earned maiden ODI call-ups for the home series against the West Indies beginning on September 27. With the three-match ODI series clashing with the Asian Games, the selectors have had to ensure there is no overlap between the two squads. All-rounder Nitish Kumar, who was originally part of the Asian Games contingent, has been pulled out of the multi-sport event and instead included in the ODI squad.

While there was speculation during the ODIs against England in July that Rohit Sharma may no longer be part of India's plans, the senior opener shrugged off the chatter by scoring a hundred in the final game at Lord's. Rohit, Virat Kohli and Ravindra Jadeja are all part of the ODI series against the men from the Caribbean, providing vast experience to the Shubman Gill-led squad. Hardik Pandya, who hasn't played since the IPL due to injury, will have to wait for his return. He is likely to feature for India-A in three One-Dayers against Australia-A in Puducherry from October 6 to 11. India will also be playing five T20Is against the West Indies. Jasprit Bumrah, who will spearhead the attack at the Asian Games, has been rested for these matches. The selectors also announced the Rest of India squad for the Irani Cup against Jammu & Kashmir,



Naman Dhir. FILE PHOTO

which will be played from October 1 to 5 at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium in Srinagar. Rishabh Pant, who has been omitted from the matches against WI, will lead the Rest of India squad.

**India's ODI squad vs. WI:** Shubman Gill (Capt.), K.L. Rahul (Vice-capt.), Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli, Ruturaj Gaikwad, Dhruv Jurel (wk), Nitish Kumar, Ravindra Jadeja, Kuldeep Yadav, Prasidh Krishna, Gurnoor Brar, Mohammed Siraj, Auqib Nabi, Yashasvi Jaiswal, Naman Dhir. **The schedule:** Sept. 27 (Thiruvananthapuram), Sept. 30 (Guwahati) and Oct. 3 (New Chandigarh). **India's T20I squad vs. WI:** Shreyas Iyer (Capt.), Tilak Varma (Vice-capt.), Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ishan Kishan (wk), Sanju Samson (wk), Shivam Dube, Kuldeep Yadav, Axar Patel, Washington Sundar, Ravi Bishnoi, Nitish Kumar, Arshdeep Singh, Prince Yadav, Mayank Yadav. **The dates:** Oct. 6 (Lucknow), Oct. 9 (Ranchi), Oct. 11 (Indore), Oct. 14 (Hyderabad) and Oct. 17 (Bengaluru). **Rest of India squad for Irani Cup (Oct. 1 to 5 in Srinagar):** Rishabh Pant (Capt. & wk), Sarfaraz Khan (Vice-capt.), Sanat Sengwan, Shikhar Mahan, Sudip Gharami, Smaran Ravichandran, Manav Suthar, Saransh Jain, Akash Deep\*, Mukesh Kumar, Mukesh Choudhary, Aryan Juyal (wk), Aryan Pandey, Anukul Roy, Ayush Doseja. \* Subject to fitness.

WPL 2027 from Jan. 14 to Feb. 7

Press Trust of India  
NEW DELHI

The fifth edition of the Women's Premier League will be played from January 14 to February 7, 2027 while its auction will be held on October 28 this year in Kochi, the BCCI announced on Wednesday. The BCCI however did not disclose the host cities for the WPL. "As the biggest T20 league in women's cricket, the TATA WPL has established itself as a significant platform for the growth of the sport, bringing together leading players from India and around the world while creating opportunities for emerging talent to perform at the highest level," said the BCCI. The Player Retention deadline is set for September 28. "The five franchises will have the opportunity to retain players from their existing squads as they begin putting their combinations in place," the BCCI added.

India beats Thailand but Arjun loses; women have it easy

CHESS OLYMPIAD

Sports Bureau

It wasn't quite the perfect start for India at the Chess Olympiad in Samarkand on Wednesday. The women won 4-0 against Dominican Republic alright, but the men's team, though expectedly victorious against Thailand, suffered a shock loss on the top board. Arjun Erigaisi was humbled by Prin Laohawirapap, who is rated 396 Elo points below him. That meant India could win only 3-1. Arjun, with white pieces, was struggling against the clock, and after he took his queen to the wrong square on the 50th move and was doomed. He resigned just four moves later. There were wins, however, for Nihal Sarin, D. Gukesh and Vidit Gujrathi. R. Praggnanandhaa, India's top-board player, was benched for the match.



Smooth start: The women's team of Humpy, Vaishali, Vantika and Savitha Shri broke no sweat in scoring victories. FIDE

In the women's match against Dominican Republic, Koneru Humpy, R. Vaishali, Vantika Agrawal and B. Savitha Shri won their games. India is the defending champion in both the open and women's sections. The opening day also saw Pakistan making a political move. It refused to play against Israel and gave a walkover (0-4). **Important results:** **Open: India bt Thailand 3-1** (Arjun Erigaisi lost to Prin Laohawirapap; Nihal Sarin bt Thanadon Kulpruethanon; D. Gukesh bt Faris Alriyami; Vidit Gujrathi bt Tupfah Khumnarokaew). **USA bt Iraq 3.5-0.5;** Uzbekistan bt Jamaica 4-0; China bt Uganda 4-0; Germany bt Faroe Islands 4-0; Azerbaijan bt Morocco 4-0; Hungary bt Malta 2.5-1.5; France bt Tunisia 4-0. **Women: India bt Dominican Republic 4-0** (Koneru Humpy bt Franchesca Ramirez Luzon; R. Vaishali bt Miguelina De La Rosa Martinez; Vantika Agrawal bt Mary Loly Gonzalez Peguero; B. Savitha Shri bt Karla Mya Nunez Diaz). **Uzbekistan bt Uganda 4-0;** Georgia bt Tunisia 4-0; Kazakhstan bt Botswana 4-0; China bt Zambia 4-0; Ukraine bt Iraq 4-0; Azerbaijan bt Guatemala 4-0; France bt Morocco 4-0; Poland bt Zimbabwe 4-0.

An even contest in the offing on the hard-courts of Seoul

DAVIS CUP

N. Sudarshan

India is not an elite tennis nation. Yet, it is among the elite 15 still remaining in this year's Davis Cup, a position it last attained in 2011 as part of the 16-team World Group in the erstwhile Cup format. Starting Friday, India will attempt to soar higher when it takes on South Korea in round two of the Davis Cup Qualifiers. At stake in Seoul is a place in the Finals, an ultra-elite grouping of eight nations including defending champion Italy. "It's a mix of pressure and motivation," India No. 1 Sumit Nagal told *The Hindu* from Seoul. "There is always pressure when you play for the country. There is motivation as well because we have never been in this situation. We are going to put our hearts into it." Fine performances against higher-ranked European nations, like the 3-1



Much at stake: The Indian team will strive to make it to the ultra-elite group of eight nations. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

victory over Switzerland in September 2025 and the 3-2 success over Netherlands earlier in 2026, have been the catalysts. Luck has been a factor too. Switzerland and Netherlands didn't have all of their best players, and now South Korea is ranked just three places above (16 to India's 19). In fact, of the countries still in the tournament, which include heavyweights such as Spain,

France, the United States and Germany, the bottom three are South Korea, India and Ecuador (23). This makes the upcoming hard-court tie an even contest. In Soonwoo Kwon, Korea has a multiple-time Tour titlist and someone ranked World No. 52 in 2021. The 28-year-old is returning after 18 months of compulsory military service, and is back up to No. 157. Hyeon Chung, 30, has

had an injury-ravaged career, but was in the top-20 in 2018 and even beat Novak Djokovic at the Australian Open that year. Kwon and Chung fashioned the memorable 3-2 triumph over Argentina in February 2026. "They are good, and they have played the ATP-level for many years," said Nagal. "Kwon is a good baseliner and Chung has a lot of experience. It's going to be tough." India's trump card may again be the big-serving Dhakshinewar Suresh. The 26-year-old is not yet a regular on the Tour, but has a 4-0 Davis Cup record and won both his singles and doubles rubbers against Netherlands. "The courts are pretty slow but I still have to use my weapons and stay more patient than rushing through the points," opined Dhakshinewar. "But you have to adapt, like playing on the Tour, because conditions will be different every week."

## A photograph of Rafael Nadal, a professional tennis player, smiling and clapping his hands. He is wearing a dark blue jacket over a black shirt. The background is blurred, showing a crowd of spectators in a stadium setting.

CM  
YK

R. Kaushik

One of the hallmarks of a champion outfit is the propensity to eke out match-turning performances from different quarters and not depend on just one or two individuals to carry the day. India are nothing if not a champion outfit, their 20-over June misadventures in Ireland and England notwithstanding. There is a reason why they have won the last two T20 World Cups, there is a reason why they have been able to tide over potentially crippling loss of personnel through injuries and still put out formidable, fighting fit units.

India have numerous fallback options for almost every position when it comes to the T20 format, specifically. Especially from a batting standpoint, there is so much depth and quality and choices that it is inevitable that many who might have walked into any other side are not even on the fringes of consideration for selection. Why, India didn't think twice before giving Suryakumar Yadav the heave-ho immediately after the Mumbaikar masterminded a successful defence of the World Cup, and that too on home soil - neither feat accomplished previously. His middling to ordinary form overshadowed his leadership and man-management chops as preparations for the next World Cup began immediately after the trophy was lifted in Ahmedabad in March.

For the longest time, Suryakumar was ranked the No. 1 T20I batter globally and even though his form slumped dramatically in his last 15 months in charge, he still has plenty of cricket left in him. Yet, to sever ties ruthlessly pointed to prudence over sentiment, never mind if it wasn't a popular call or, to many, even an immediately warranted one.

While there are deserving and excellent alternatives for most roles within the Indian cricketing landscape, the one most coveted for obvious reasons is a fast-bowling all-rounder. So many countries take that spot for granted, almost. Even today, Australia have Mitchell Marsh (who doesn't bowl so much these days) and Marcus Stoinis, not to mention Cameron Green and Beau Webster. England have a long list, as do South Africa who, since their return from isolation, have thrown up numerous such luminaries. West Indies too can dip into that giving bag while New Zealand have a generous assortment to select from.

India, though, haven't always been blessed with an overflowing cup when it comes to this specific requirement. There have been all-rounders of various degrees of proficiency in the post-Kapil Dev era, with Irfan Pathan perhaps being the most successful of the lot. It was a given that Kapil was irreplaceable; the Haryana Hurricane was a generational genius and any quest to unearth a like-for-like substitute was always going to be an exercise in futility. As India meandered from one alternative to another, they stumbled upon Hardik Pandya, a natural athlete who could crank up the pace, who struck the ball a mile and who was an electric fielder.

Pandya slammed a century and snared a five-wicket in his brief Test career - 11 Tests in 13 months between July 2017 and August 2018 - but taking a cue from his complaining body, decided that the longer version was not his cup of tea. It wasn't that the spirit wasn't willing, but his body couldn't take the load of Test cricket. India would have loved for Pandya to keep continuing to play the five-day game but instead were happy to settle for his services in the two white-ball versions, though even there, he has been compelled to miss increasingly more matches in the last couple of years as he sidles towards his mid-30s.

The closest India now have to a Pandya sub is Nitish Kumar, himself no stranger to injuries though he is only 23 and has been an international for exactly as many months. Nitish's appearances for the country across the three formats has been restricted to a mere 22 games - 10 in Tests and six apiece in ODIs and T20Is, not so much because he has been considered superfluous to requirement as owing to the fact that he has often been unavailable for selection.

This ongoing Afghanistan series marks another comeback from the infirmary for the young man from the port city of Visakhapatnam. In June, he picked up a quadriceps injury that kept him away from the twin tours of Ireland and England, and the subsequent three-match sojourn in Zimbabwe. The quadriceps problem is the latest in an already long and burgeoning list of injuries - hernia (June 2024), side strain (January 2025), knee (July 2025), neck spasms (October 2025) and quadriceps (also October 2025).

Around all this, in his desire to become the 'best all-rounder' (his words), Nitish embarked on a mission to ramp up his pace, ahead of IPL 2026. After watching *Instagram* videos on biomechanics and fast bowling, he got in touch with protagonist Steffan Jones, the Englishman who plied his fast-bowling wares on the county circuit for 20 years and played three years of professional rugby too. An unforgiving one-week crash course ahead of the tournament helped Nitish add a staggering 10 kilometres per hour to his



# Tight-rope walk with a coveted resource

The soft-spoken young man with a ready smile is currently back in business again, and hopefully this time, it won't be just another cameo appearance

SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

**Nitish's inconsistencies, especially with the ball, can be easily explained away simply because he is still reasonably inexperienced, with less than 1,000 overs under his belt in representative cricket. Internationally, he has bowled a little over 125 overs (for 16 wickets)**

bowling as he went from late 120s to 140 occasionally, but whether that has come at a cost remains to be seen.

Nitish's career, still in its infancy, is already a tale of what might be. Every performance of promise has been followed by a trough, either through loss of form or because of the unwelcome injury malady. When he made a spectacular breakthrough hundred in the Boxing Day Test at the MCG in December 2024, Nitish seemed to have made himself undroppable, but for various reasons, he has only played six subsequent Tests. Among them was the third of five Tests against England at Lord's last year, when he picked up two quick wickets to stymie a blazing start by the hosts, but he was forced to miss the rest of the series with a knee injury.

The soft-spoken young man with a ready smile is currently back in business again, and hopefully this time, it won't be another cameo appearance. As if to reiterate the value he brings to the side, Nitish walked away with the Player of the Match award in the second T20I against Afghanistan on Tuesday for his three for

24 from three good overs. A wicket with the first delivery of each of his three overs did the trick as the Afghans failed to touch 160 for the second time in three nights, allowing India to breeze home on the back of the pyrotechnics of openers Sanju Samson and Abhishek Sharma. Abhishek was the Player of the Match in the big win in the series-opener, showing that India boast match-winners aplenty at both ends of the spectrum.

#### Scope for improvement

Nitish's inconsistencies, especially with the ball, can be easily explained away simply because he is still reasonably inexperienced, with less than 1,000 overs under his belt in representative cricket. Internationally, he has bowled a little over 125 overs (for 16 wickets) and it might appear a stretch to label him an all-rounder immediately, but while he may not be able to influence - yet - the course of a match with his bowling alone, one can state with confidence that he will be a force to reckon with with the ball too once he manages to keep himself free from injuries.

Nitish's immediate aim will be to steer clear of injuries for at least the next two and a half months, build up a decent volume of bowling work - at the very minimum - and remain in the fray for selection for the two Test matches in New Zealand in November. There are a host of white-ball internationals between now and November 19, when the first Test gets underway at Wellington's Basin Reserve, for Nitish to achieve that goal, starting with Thursday's final T20I in New Delhi. He has been withdrawn from the Asian

Games where India will kick off their gold medal defence in the quarterfinals on September 28. Instead, he will figure in three ODIs followed by five T20Is at home against West Indies, and as many such contests in New Zealand that will segue into five further ODIs before the Test series begins.

At No. 8, where he will most likely slot in should he be available, Nitish will offer the balance India so desperately crave away from the subcontinent. It was from that position that he uncorked a fabulous hundred against the Aussies, which means there is batting depth as well as an additional pace bowling choice which is so essential on what are certain to be seaming surfaces in New Zealand. Nitish's presence will allow Shubman Gill to go into with three frontline quicks and still have five proper bowling options - Ravindra Jadeja should provide variety and experience with his left-arm spin - which is such an essential requirement in the quest for 20 wickets that could translate into victory and 12 World Test Championship points.

The recent prolificacy of the Indian top order hasn't allowed Nitish to have a bat internationally since January, and maybe there is a case for him to be pushed up the order from time to time so that he has competitive game-time in that discipline as well. As those who have played the game at any level - and even those who haven't - have pointed out repeatedly, there is no substitute for time in the middle. No number of balls hit at nets will replicate the intensity of a match scenario and India wouldn't want Nitish to go in cold from a batting standpoint when the Test matches come around with so much hinging on the outcome. That's where Gill and head coach Gautam Gambhir will have to walk the tricky tightrope of balancing the immediate (results) with the immediate future (match readiness).

India have been forced to approach several fixtures in the recent past with the full complement never available for selection. Some of the 'offenders' in the injury list fall in the 'serial' category - Jasprit Bumrah, Pandya (who hasn't represented the country since March), Harshit Rana, Washington Sundar and Nitish.

Despite the depth that speaks to the vibrancy of Indian cricket, this is far from an ideal scenario. Gill, the Test and ODI boss, and T20I captain Shreyas Iyer, will be desperate for the luxury of picking from the complete riches. Nitish might not be on top of the 'riches' section, but he is a much-coveted resource whose progress over the next 75 days will be followed with interest. And optimism.

#### THE GIST

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# India has a research blindspot: its own science system

The country needs to invest in metascience, in institutions, expertise, and people whose job is to study how Indian science actually works; it means documenting what has worked and what has not, instead of forgetting it with every change in leadership

Moumita Koley

The U.S. Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) recently released a 125-page policy document titled ‘Science: A New Golden Age’, which presents a renewed vision for American science. It positions itself as a sequel to the American inventor Vannevar Bush’s 1945 report, ‘Science: The Endless Frontier’, which laid the foundations of the famously successful post-war American research system.

As it happens, the new report can be consequential for the Indian science system as well – by revealing the importance of something that India currently does not have but should as quickly as possible: the ability to study its own science system with evidence.

**Why a system works**

The report starts with a diagnosis well known to the science-of-science, or metascience, research community: despite sustained increases in research and development investment, returns in scientific productivity and innovation have not kept pace. But more than agreement or disagreement with this diagnosis, what matters is that a system should be able to interrogate itself using its own data and be able to reach a conclusion like this.

After its diagnosis, the report draws two conclusions worth exploring. First, it says the U.S. should invest more in individual researchers with bold, high-risk ideas rather than routing funds primarily through what it calls “legacy institutions”. Second, it calls into question the prevailing one-size-fits-all model of research funding, instead advocating for experimenting with alternative funding mechanisms. It also calls for funding agencies to evaluate whether their own mechanisms can be made more effective.

The institutions that fund science should be accountable for the evidence that what they fund and why are actually working – and not just in the U.S. Across Europe, the U.K., China, and Japan, governments and funders are investing seriously in metascience that is able to address this concern. Governments and the people need concrete answers to how their research systems actually function: specifically, how it sets funding priorities, how funding mechanisms perform, how peer-review behaves, how it assesses researchers, how its incentives affect the way scientists collaborate, and so on.

**Building a memory**

In India, this conversation has barely begun. The country’s science system has historically been shaped by the experience, judgment, and leadership of eminent scientists. That experience is invaluable and must remain a source of evidence – but it is also no longer sufficient considering today’s research ecosystem is far more complex than it was half a century ago, and



The institutions that fund science should be accountable for the evidence that what they fund, and why, are actually working. GETTY IMAGES

understanding it requires systematic analysis. Specifically, it needs to draw on economics, the sociology of science, political science, public policy, organisational studies, scientometrics, and history and philosophy.

An exploration of bibliographic databases shows that, between 1950 and 2024, Indian publications addressing metascience or closely related questions across these domains remained low. Except for scientometrics, Indian research in these areas accounted for only around 1-2% of global research output, with the total number of publications generally not exceeding a hundred over the entire period.

A related problem is institutional memory. As leadership and personnel change, experiential knowledge about what worked, what failed, and why is lost. India has very few publicly available analytical reports documenting the evolution of its research system, and little that carries institutional learning across successive generations of policymakers. Building that memory is itself part of building better science governance, and it is where metascience can have a significant impact.

For these reasons, India needs to invest in scientific research as well as in the capacity to study the ecosystem in which this research happens.

**Reason of state**

The OSTP report also called for setting clearer national scientific goals to streamline research efforts and speed up the translation of discoveries into technologies, including those for society’s benefit. This, too, is worth taking seriously but also debating carefully because it understates how much of

transformative science begins without any defined mission at all, i.e. as curiosity-driven research. And this, again, is precisely the kind of question a meaningful metascience capacity would allow India to debate with evidence rather than insights alone.

Quantum mechanics emerged in the early 20th century to answer fundamental questions about the nature of matter. It later became the foundation of semiconductors, lasers, and modern computing. Decades of curiosity-driven research in molecular biology, with no application in sight, eventually made CRISPR gene-editing and mRNA vaccines possible. The mathematics underlying today’s artificial intelligence – including neural networks and transformer architectures – emerged from exploratory research in statistical mechanics.

The economist Mariana Mazzucato has documented this pattern in her work on what she calls “the entrepreneurial state”. She has shown that many of the technologies in a single iPhone, including the internet, GPS, touchscreen, and the voice-recognition algorithms behind Siri, have their roots in blue-sky research funded by U.S. federal agencies such as DARPA and the National Institutes of Health. All these were undertaken decades before any company saw commercial application potential in them. In her account, the state was a bold and patient investor that was absorbing risks no private venture would touch. This is the kind of long-horizon, curiosity-driven investment that a purely ‘mission and metrics’ approach to funding – like what increasingly prevails in India today – risks crowding out. But at the same time, mission-oriented research has its own record of delivery. The Apollo programme

forced rapid advances in aerospace engineering, materials science, and computing that spread far beyond the space race. The Human Genome Project turned biology into a coordinated, global, infrastructure-scale enterprise. India itself had the Green Revolution, where crop-breeding research backed by state investment and clear food-security goals transformed the country’s relationship with hunger within a single generation. The Revolution has its own legitimate critics as well, regarding ecological costs, regional inequity, and long-term sustainability. But that very disagreement also makes the case for India to be able to evaluate a mission using evidence.

**Striking the balance**

A healthy research ecosystem may well need both approaches to research, with research on a mission being used to meet pressing challenges and curiosity-driven, blue-sky research to open new frontiers. It is just that any decision on where to strike that balance should rest on deliberation and evidence, rather than on which topics happen to be fashionable in global policy discourse at a given moment.

To facilitate that, India needs to invest in metascience, in institutions, expertise, and people whose job is to study how Indian science actually works. It means documenting what has worked and what has not, instead of forgetting it with every change in leadership, and building institutions strong enough to imagine an ambitious future for Indian science.

(Moumita Koley is a senior research analyst at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. moumita.chem@gmail.com)

## THE SCIENCE QUIZ

### Scientific problems featuring cities

Vasudevan Mukunth

**QUESTION 1**

The X paradox refers to a game where people get double the payout when a coin lands heads — yet people tend to pay only a small amount to play. The Swiss mathematician Nicolas Bernoulli used this paradox to challenge expected-value theory. Name X.

**QUESTION 2**

In this game, there are three pegs and discs of increasing size stacked on one peg (with the smallest on top). The goal is to move the whole stack to another peg, one disc at a time, while never placing a larger disc on a smaller one. The game originated in 1883. Name it.

**QUESTION 3**

The U.S. economist \_\_\_\_\_ once asked: if you must meet a stranger in New York City tomorrow, with no

way to communicate, where and when would you go? The economist used the question to show how people participating in coordination games are often guided by shared cultural expectations. Fill in the blanks.

**QUESTION 4**

In 1692, the Italian mathematician Vincenzo Viviani put forth a challenge: cut four equal windows into a hemispherical dome so that the remaining curved surface can be exactly squared, meaning its area can be expressed without using  $\pi$ . This, called the \_\_\_\_\_ problem, was an important result in geometry. Fill in the blank.

**QUESTION 5**

Can you double the volume of a cube using only a compass and a ruler? This is one of the classic construction problems, named for the Greek city of Z, which is also the birthplace of Apollo in Greek mythology. Nineteenth century mathematicians proved this is impossible to do. Name Z.

**Answers to September 10 quiz:**

1. Continent hosting vast majority of world’s glacial ice – **Ans: Antarctica**

2. Warm continent that last had glaciers 19,000 years ago – **Ans:**

**Australia**

3. Glacier that is site of world’s highest altitude battlefield – **Ans: Siachen**

4. Substance that is mostly locked away in glaciers, ice sheets – **Ans: Freshwater**

5. Country with the most glaciers outside polar regions – **Ans: Pakistan**

**First contact:**

K.N. Viswanathan | Mansi Rathod | Athul K. | Harsh Kumar | Muhammed Rafid



**Visual:** Name this city. Its name is part of a famous problem involving seven bridges — one of which is visible to the right here — that Leonhard Euler solved in 1736. GUMEROV ILDAR/PUBLIC DOMAIN



Space agencies are targeting the moon’s south pole region, where permanently shadowed craters are supposed to hold large quantities of water ice. GETTY IMAGES

## Cities on the moon may run dry far faster than space barons think

Vasudevan Mukunth

As NASA and China speed up their lunar space programmes, a more-than-temporary human settlement on the moon inches closer to reality. Space agencies with these plans are targeting the moon’s south pole region, where permanently shadowed craters are supposed to hold large quantities of water ice.

In the long-term, entrepreneurs like Jeff Bezos have argued for moving heavy industries to the moon while Elon Musk has said the satellite can support a “self-growing city”. As on the earth, water is at the centre of these plans.

But a new study by two astronomers, Martin Elvis of the Smithsonian Astrophysical Observatory and Jonathan McDowell of Durham University, has thrown up a reality check. The duo has estimated that even if the moon hosted one billion tonnes of water, it would support a population of only one million people for roughly a century if they recycled 98% of it.

The findings were published in *Frontiers in Space Technologies*.

The scientists arrived at this estimate based on calculations of how much water the moon may really hold, how much electricity people and industrial activities consume, how much water a human settlement might need, and how efficiently that water can be reused.

Right now, the exact quantity of water on the moon is a major source of uncertainty, and which scientists are studying using robotic missions like India’s Chandrayaan and China’s Chang’e programmes. One 2022 study of 65 large permanently shadowed craters estimated that eight of them together hold around 34 million tonnes of water.

Against this backdrop, Elvis and McDowell assumed 1 billion tonnes of water as a generous baseline – around 4 lakh Olympic-sized swimming pools – and the demand to amount to 500 tonnes per person per year.

(The duo also estimated that a city of one million inhabitants would require around 2 GW of power, which can be sourced relatively easily from solar panels and nuclear reactors.)

Without recycling, this will sustain a million people for only around two years. But with 98% recycling, they estimated that a million people will deplete a billion tonnes of water in a century, and a lakh people in a millennium.

They also found one million people could have water for a millennium if they recycled the water to the tune of 99.75% – essentially living like the fictitious Fremmen tribe in the ‘Dune’ books and films.

At present, NASA has said it will set up a permanent outpost near the moon’s south pole from the 2030s under its ‘Moon Base’ programme. China’s ‘International Lunar Research Station’ plans for a basic station by 2035 that will be built out in the 2040s.

India itself is planning a crewed landing on the moon by 2040. In August, NASA also invited the Indian Space Research Organisation to participate in the ‘Moon Base’.

Since Elvis and McDowell assumed a minimum population of one lakh for their analysis, the findings don’t apply to short-duration missions or small lunar outposts. But as these outposts expand, the study suggests, the space agencies and the governments behind them may have to treat water on the moon as a strategic resource.

**For feedback and suggestions** for ‘Science’, please write to [science@thehindu.co.in](mailto:science@thehindu.co.in) with the subject ‘Daily page’

# Text & Context

THE HINDU

## NEWS IN NUMBERS

**Decline in Manipur's revenue amid ethnic conflict in 2023-26**

**1,200** Manipur Chief Minister Y. Khemchand Singh on Wednesday said the prolonged ethnic conflict in the State resulted in a decline of over ₹1,200 crore in GST revenue from 2023 to 2026. The ethnic conflict has claimed at least 306 lives, with 49 people still missing and thousands rendered homeless, officials said. PTI

**Number of additional employees coming under the EPFO**

**51** in lakh. The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a proposal to raise the wage ceiling for mandatory coverage under the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) to ₹25,000 per month from ₹15,000. The wage ceiling revision is taking place after 12 years. The decision is expected to bring more than 51 lakh additional employees within the ambit of EPFO coverage. PTI

**Household listing blocks covered in Bengal Census phase 1**

**1.73** in lakh. West Bengal has completed 100% of the fieldwork for the first phase of the Census, covering all 1,73,066 HLBs across the State ahead of the September 14 deadline, CM Suvenhu Adhikari said. Over 3.68 crore census houses have also been enumerated against a projected 3.69 crore, representing nearly 99.7% of the expected households. PTI

**Number of casualties in Sudan gold mine collapse**

**67** The tragedy happened in the al-Zara gold mine in the town of Nuhud in West Kordofan province. The area is under the control of the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces, which have been at war with the country's military for over three years. Survivors said the collapse occurred late Tuesday, and many people remain missing at the mine. PTI

**Number of vehicles to be seized from police stations in Bengaluru**

**11,000** Karnataka Minister Krishna Byre Gowda on Wednesday launched a drive to shift over 11,000 seized vehicles from police station premises across the city to seven designated locations, aimed at clearing the premises and easing inconvenience to the public. PTI  
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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# What lies beyond India's E20 push

The E20 blend's promised savings were offset by lower mileage, with consumers spending an estimated ₹88,234 cr. extra over the last three years; its benefits for emissions and forex savings are uncertain, as higher fuel consumption can raise emissions while diverting crops to ethanol can affect food security and exports

## ECONOMIC NOTES

Rohit Azad  
Shouvik Chakraborty  
Indranil Chowdhury

A litre of E20 petrol consists of 80% motor gasoline and 20% anhydrous ethanol. According to a press release by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, India first introduced it on February 6, 2023, when public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) began selling it at select outlets across the country.

### E20 promise

E20 has been scaled up this year because of rising crude prices resulting from unilateral American aggression against Iran and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz in response. The government has made three broad claims in favour of using the E20 blend – savings for the consumer, lower carbon emissions, and forex savings. However, if the E20 blend reduces mileage, these claims may not hold. That the loss in mileage is real was accepted in a written reply to the Lok Sabha by Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari, who stated that E20 reduces fuel economy by “2% to 6% depending on vehicle category and vintage,” citing a joint ARAI-SIAM-IOCL study. There is also anecdotal evidence from many car users, especially those using cars of vintage 2022 or earlier, that E20 has brought mileage down, perhaps by far more than 6%, as well as caused damage to their engines and oil tanks. It is difficult to quantify the possible engine damage this blend may cause, but these three claims are empirically verifiable.

### Has it saved Indians some cash?

The first claim is that since the E20 blend uses less crude, which is expensive, and more ethanol, which is cheaper, a higher share of ethanol will save Indians money. This, it is claimed, would also help keep inflation in check. But what this claim does not take into account is the loss in mileage (km/litre) that a higher ethanol blend leads to. Since ethanol releases less energy per litre burnt than pure gasoline, there is a consequent loss of mileage per litre, especially in engines that are not compatible with the E20 blend.

Let us say E10 blend petrol used to cost ₹100, and E20 was introduced while keeping prices the same, which is what happened.

Consider an average mileage of 15 km/litre for a standard car running on the E10 blend. If there is a 6% loss in mileage with E20, the car would now need 1.06 litres to travel those 15 km. This means shelling out ₹106 instead of ₹100 for the same distance travelled. Aggregate this over many customers and many kilometres, and you get the loss that households have to bear. The greater the loss in mileage, the greater the cost to the household would be.

An extensive report prepared by The Reporters Collective and authored by Ayushi Kar shows that, instead of savings, the households had to spend extra as a result of this loss in mileage. **Chart 1** shows that over the last three years, Indian consumers had to shell out an additional ₹88,234 crore, with the burden rising every year. If the defence is that prices would have been much higher had the E10 blend continued, there are other ways in which prices could be kept under check, at least in the short run.

### The question of emissions

On the face of it, E20 is definitely a

## India's changing fuel mix



**BOX 1: Emissions calculations for 15 kms travelled by an average Indian car**

|                               | E10                         | E20                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Emissions*                    | 2.32 KgCO <sub>2</sub> /ltr | 2.23 KgCO <sub>2</sub> /ltr                        |
| WITH 6% LOSS OF MILEAGE       |                             |                                                    |
| Petrol needed                 | 1 ltr                       | 1.06 ltr                                           |
| Emissions                     | 2.32 KgCO <sub>2</sub> (A)  | 2.23 x 1.06 = 2.37 KgCO <sub>2</sub> (B)           |
| Excess Emissions if using E20 |                             | 0.05 KgCO <sub>2</sub> (B-A) = 50 gCO <sub>2</sub> |

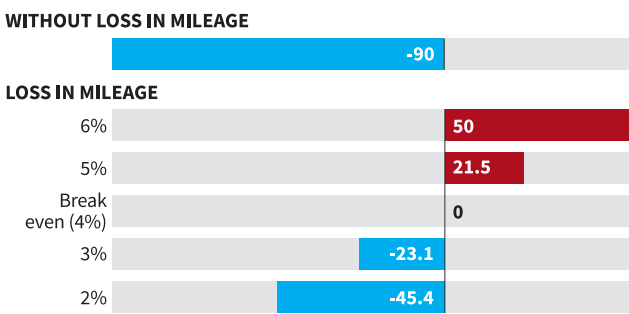
\*Note: 1. Emissions data has been taken from the Federal Register EPA, which reports E10 emissions to be 8.78 kgCO<sub>2</sub>/gallon and pure ethanol's 5.75 kgCO<sub>2</sub>/gallon. 1 gallon = 3.79 ltr  
2. We calculate the implicit emissions from 100% gasoline, which is 9.12 KgCO<sub>2</sub>/gallon, and use that to generate E20 emissions.

**CHART 1: E20's extra cost to Indian consumers** (in ₹ crores)



**Chart:** Ayushi Kar (2027) "In 3 years, Indian motorists paid ₹88,234 crore extra fuel Modi govt's Great Ethanol Experiment", Reporters Collective

**CHART 2: Do the CO<sub>2</sub> emissions decline with E20?**  
(Difference in emissions between E20 and E10 in gCO<sub>2</sub> per 15 km of an average Indian car)



See box 1 for details

**Chart:** Authors' calculations | **Source:** Federal Register, EPA

cleaner fuel simply because less carbon is embodied per litre of ethanol (**Box 1**). But, as we saw above, with a loss in mileage, the same 15 km now requires 1.06 litres of petrol, which means emissions could be higher for the same distance travelled. Box 1 shows the difference in emissions if there is such a loss in mileage.

In Chart 2, we present the rise or fall in emissions using this calculation for the entire range of mileage losses given by the Minister. The calculations show that emissions would rise (red bars), rather than fall, if the loss in mileage is in the range of 4% to 6%. Emissions fall only if the loss in mileage is less than 4%.

To be sure, overall emissions per km would depend on the mix of cars of different vintages running on Indian roads. For newer cars compatible with E20, emissions are likely to decline. For older cars, on the other hand, emissions would be greater, depending on the extent of the loss in mileage. Thus, average emissions per km would depend on the weights of different vintage cars.

### E20 and foreign exchange

Any substitution away from crude will indeed save India foreign exchange since oil constitutes a significant part of the import bill.

However, the position needs to be more nuanced. First, a fall in mileage may

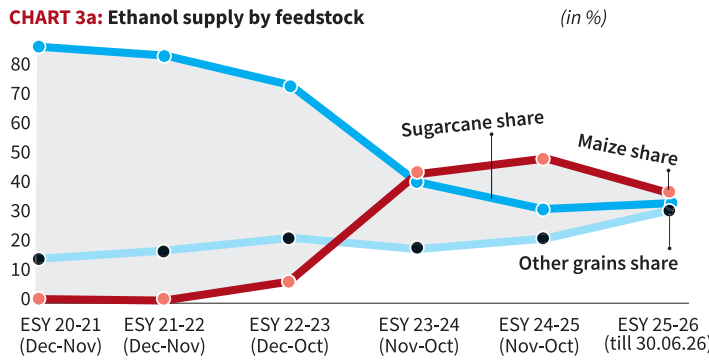
at least partially cancel out the advantage of the blend as far as forex savings are concerned. Second, the ethanol required for E20 blending needs diversion of crops and grains in favour of ethanol production. The diversion of food grains for fuel has serious implications for food security. Since E20 blending is here to stay, this is more of a long-term adjustment in the supply of such crops and grains.

A demand-production mismatch for an agricultural commodity will either be met by rising prices, cross-border trade management, or both. The resulting fall in exports, or increase in imports, or both, represents a loss of foreign exchange, undermining the very purpose that initiated the policy shift. It might be too early to ascertain the long-term impact of this policy on forex earnings, but some preliminary evidence may give us a sense of where this is headed.

The two main sources of ethanol production are sugarcane and maize (Chart 3(a)).

While India has gradually shifted away from sugarcane to maize, both crops have been affected by this policy. In the case of sugar, the government had to ban exports in 2023 as well as this year, amid rising domestic demand because of ethanol diversion. This led to a drastic fall in India's dollar earnings from sugar exports (Chart 3(b)). As for maize, with a rising

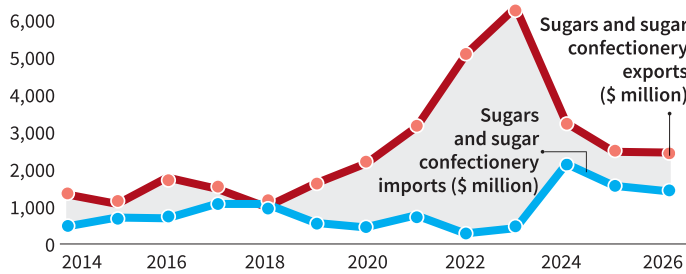
E20 promises savings and lower emissions, but mileage losses and crop diversion could offset some of its gains



ESY is Ethanol Supply Year. ESY definitions change over time: Dec-Nov for ESY20-21 and ESY21-22; Dec-Oct for ESY22-23; and Nov-Oct from ESY23-24 onward. The ESY25-26 column is a part-year figure, up to 30.06.2026

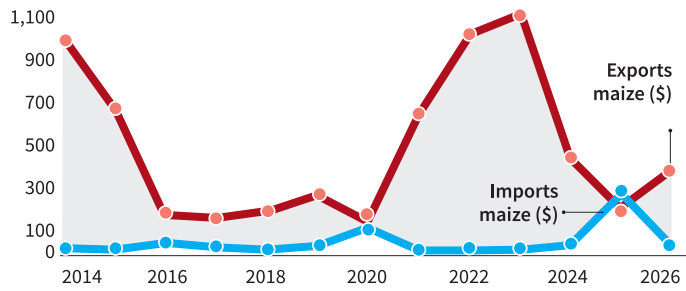
**Source:** Authors' calculations. Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, Government of India, Rajya Sabha Unstarred Question no - 1729, Answered on - 03/08/2026

**CHART 3b: Sugars and sugar confectionery trade, 2014-26**



Data for HS Code 17 - Sugars & sugar confectionery - have been used for this chart  
**Source:** Authors' calculations. Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India. Frequency is Annual, ending in "March" of each year

**CHART 3c: India — maize trade, FY2014–FY2026** (in \$ million)



**Chart:** Authors' calculations. The 8-digit HS code for maize until 2020 was 100591000 and for maize seed was 10051000, respectively. Since 2021, the codes for different maize product categories have been 10059011, 10059019, 10059020, 10059030, and 10059090. The code for maize seed remains the same. Frequency is Annual, ending in "March" of each year.  
**Source:** Ministry of Commerce and Industry, GoI

share as a source of ethanol production, export earnings have similarly plummeted over the last couple of years (Chart 3(c)). India was a net importer last year.

So, even in the narrow sense of improving forex earnings, the E20 policy may not have been entirely successful.

### The cost beyond the pump

To keep prices under control when crude prices rise, a countercyclical indirect tax policy could be introduced to insulate consumers, something that the government itself was doing until the Bengal elections were over.

As the Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) himself has argued, consumers should, at the very least, be given a choice between E10 and E20 instead of forcing a fleet of vehicles – cars and motorcycles – that are not ready for E20 to use it.

The government should also develop reliable and subsidised public transport with last-mile connectivity, along with cycling and walking options. All of these would reduce the need for cars and motorcycles, and hence emissions and pollution.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics; Additionally, Shouvik Chakraborty is Research Associate Professor at the Political Economy Research Institute, Amherst, U.S.)

## THE GIST

E20 was introduced to reduce dependence on crude, but its lower energy content can reduce fuel economy, increasing the cost of running vehicles

The emissions impact depends on the extent of mileage loss and the vehicle's vintage, while diverting sugarcane and maize to ethanol production has implications for food security and trade

The government can use countercyclical fuel taxes, offer consumers a choice between E10 and E20, and strengthen public transport, cycling and walking infrastructure to reduce fuel use and pollution

